

SURVEY RESULTS · FIRST EDITION

RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

This report sets out what 122 people from Australian grassroots football clubs, mostly committee members and volunteer coordinators, told us in 2026 about how their clubs organise volunteers, the time it takes, and the problems they run into.

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26/05/26 – 30/09/26
122 responses

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01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

About This Research

Between 26 May and 30 September 2026, 122 people involved in running grassroots football clubs completed a survey on how their clubs organise volunteers. Respondents came from at least 67 clubs across NSW, Queensland, Victoria, Western Australia and South Australia. Most are senior club officials: 86% (105) hold a committee or administrative role, and 45% (55) are office bearers. The survey asked about club size, the activities that need volunteers, the tools used, how duties are assigned, the main challenges and the weekly time spent coordinating. A follow-up question on volunteer levies was answered by 41 respondents.

122 Club officials from at least 67 clubs in five states	86% Hold a committee or administrative role	98% Named finding enough volunteers or the same people always helping as a top challenge	2.6 Tools and channels used per club to coordinate volunteers, on average	40–60_{hrs} Typical coordination admin per club, per season
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Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, n=122

Key Findings

1. **The main problem is a shortage of people.** Finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping were each named by 90% of respondents, and 98% named at least one of the two. When asked what they would change about coordination, 60% answered about getting people to help, not about organising them.
2. **A small core carries the load, and it wears them down.** 40% of clubs named volunteer burnout as a top-three challenge, rising to 54% in clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers. These small clubs cover nearly the same range of activities as clubs five times their size, and spend about 19 minutes of coordination per volunteer each week, against about 2 minutes in clubs with 100+.
3. **Coordination runs on chat apps and spreadsheets.** WhatsApp is used by 54% of clubs and spreadsheets by 39%. Only 6% use dedicated rostering software. The average club spreads the work across 2.6 tools and channels, and three in four use two or more.

4. **More channels go with more burnout.** 51% of clubs using three or more channels named burnout, against 31% of clubs using one or two. The gap held in three of four size bands. Clubs using more channels were also three times as likely to be unsure how long coordination takes (19% vs 6%). Only one respondent named "too many tools" as a challenge, so the cost is felt as tiredness, not seen as a tools problem.
5. **Coordination takes real time, and much of it goes unmeasured.** Most clubs spend 1-3 hours a week organising volunteers, or about 40-60 hours a season before anyone does a duty. Together, respondents who gave an estimate account for about 6,300 hours a season. 12% couldn't estimate their time at all.
6. **No assignment method prevents no-shows.** No-shows were named by 20-26% of clubs whether the committee assigns duties, volunteers nominate themselves, or clubs use a mix. The method changes where the work falls: committee assignment eases the supply problem but adds availability and follow-up work.
7. **Mid-sized clubs are in transition.** Clubs with 26-50 volunteers use the most channels (3.3 on average), are the most likely to name chasing confirmations (38%) and the least sure of their weekly hours (25% unsure). They have outgrown informal coordination but haven't moved to a structured system.
8. **Levies rarely solve the problem on their own.** Only 4 of 41 follow-up respondents run a levy for all families, and 4 more tried one and stopped. Of 10 who described a levy or credit scheme, 6 said it didn't increase volunteering, as families paid to opt out. The schemes with some success reward a clearly defined role.

What This Means

For club committees, the findings point to treating volunteering as a people problem first: widening the pool, making contribution visible so the load can be shared fairly, protecting the core few, and keeping the roster and its updates in one place. For associations and governing bodies, volunteer supply is a sport-wide issue that individual clubs can't fix alone. Competition-wide expectations, model policies, and targeted support for small and mid-sized clubs are likely to have the most effect.

Clubs are willing to be involved. 76% of respondents asked for these findings and 70% want to hear about practical help that is developed or piloted. With 122 responses, results for the full sample have a margin of error of about ± 9 points, and the findings are best read as a strong indication of common experience across grassroots football rather than a precise national measure.

02 · ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

Methodology

This research used an online survey of people involved in running grassroots football clubs in Australia. Most responses came through football community Facebook groups. The survey was also emailed directly to clubs and associations around Australia. The Western Sydney Wanderers shared it with grassroots clubs in their local catchment, and that brought in a good number of responses.

Responses were collected between 26 May and 30 September 2026. The survey was first hosted on Google Forms (28 responses) and later moved to a form on rosterday.com.au (94 responses). Both forms used the same questions and answer options, except that the website form added an optional question asking for the club name (Q15). All responses were saved to the same spreadsheet. The survey asked about the respondent's role, club size, how volunteers are organised and assigned, the main challenges, and the time spent coordinating each week. It ended with one open-text question, two opt-in questions about the findings, and optional contact details. Questions were worded neutrally and did not mention any product or solution. No incentive was offered for taking part.

Responses. The survey was focused on football, and all 122 responses came from football clubs.

Distinct clubs. Club name (Q15) was an optional question on the website form only, and was given in 65 responses. After standardising spelling and naming variations, those 65 responses represent 58 distinct clubs. Another 9 clubs were identified from club email addresses given by 11 respondents who didn't name their club, which brings the confirmed total to at least 67 distinct clubs. The remaining 46 respondents gave neither a club name nor a club email address, so 67 is a floor, not the full count. The identified clubs are in NSW, Queensland, Victoria, Western Australia and South Australia.

Engagement. 76% of respondents (93) asked to receive a summary of the findings (Q12). 70% (85) asked to hear about anything developed or piloted from this work (Q13). 94 respondents (77%) left a contact email.

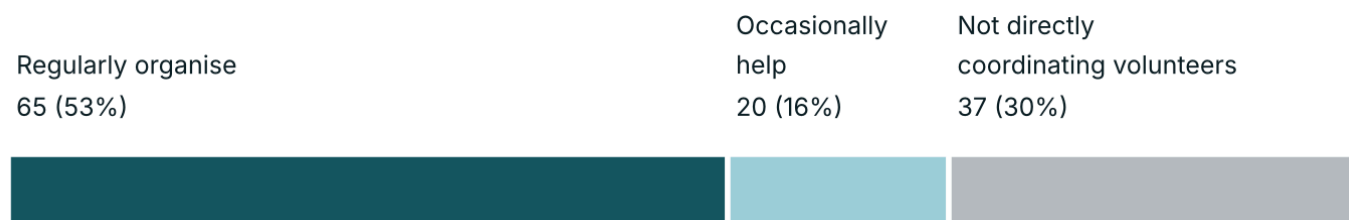
Data handling. All responses are held only by RosterDay. Results are reported as totals, and quotes are anonymised, attributed by role and club size only. Club names and emails are not published. Club names, and club email addresses where no name was given, were used to count distinct clubs. Respondents who asked for the findings were also sent the follow-up question on volunteer levies. Only those who opted in at Q13 will hear about anything developed or piloted. Respondents can ask to have their response deleted, or ask not to be contacted again, by emailing hello@rosterday.com.au.

Who We Surveyed

Seven in ten respondents (70%) organise volunteers themselves: 53% regularly and 16% occasionally. The other 30% (37) hold club roles but don't coordinate volunteers themselves. Most are in club leadership, so they see volunteer coordination closely even if they don't run it.

Seven in ten respondents organise volunteers themselves

Involvement in organising volunteers at their club (Q1, n=122)



Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q1, n=122

Chart 1: Involvement in volunteer coordination (Q1)

A Note On Interpreting This Data

Sample size. With 122 responses, percentages for the full sample have a margin of error of about ± 9 percentage points at 95% confidence. Treat differences of less than 10 points between results as not meaningful. For subgroups the range is wider: for example, about ± 12 points for the 65 regular organisers.

Self-selection. As with any voluntary survey, people chose whether to take part. Those with a strong interest in volunteer coordination may have been more likely to respond. The survey was shared through broad community channels (Facebook groups, an A-League club's grassroots network, and direct emails to clubs and associations), not to clubs selected for having volunteer problems. Respondents also covered a range of roles and club sizes. The findings describe what these 122 club officials told us. They are best read as a strong indication of common experience across grassroots football, not as a precise national measure. Respondents to the website form could see that RosterDay was running the survey, although no question mentioned RosterDay or any product.

Respondents, not clubs. Each response is one person's view. Of the 67 identified clubs, 64 sent a single response, so the results are not concentrated in a few clubs. The survey did not ask which state a club is in, so results cannot be broken down by state.

03 · RESPONDENT PROFILE

All 122 respondents were from football (soccer) clubs. Seven answered "No" to Q1 (whether they help organise volunteers) but went on to complete the survey. They're kept in the base because their answers on club size and volunteer frequency are still valid.

Club Roles Represented

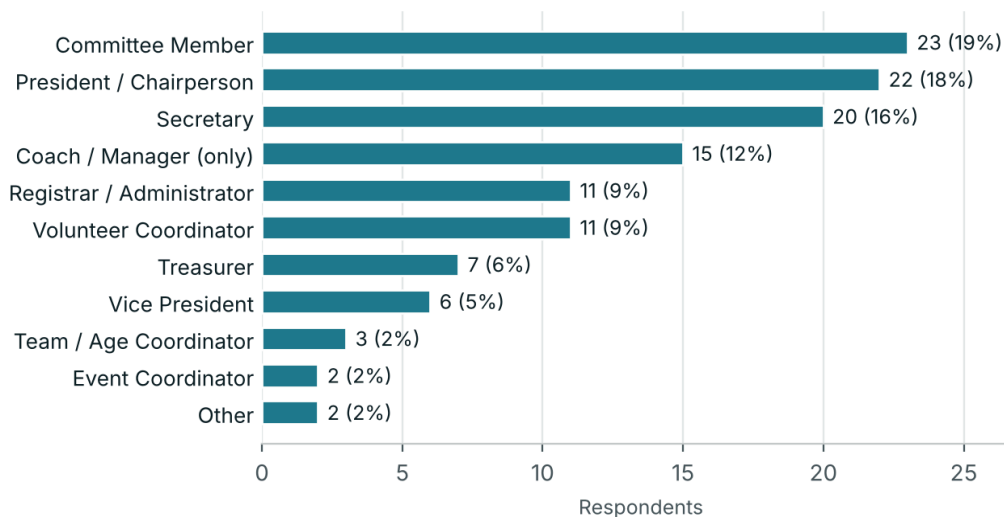
Most respondents hold senior roles at their club. Based on the highest role each person selected:

- 45% (55) are office bearers: president or chairperson, vice president, secretary or treasurer.
- Adding committee members, registrars, team/age coordinators, and volunteer and event coordinators, 86% (105) hold a committee or administrative role.
- Only 12% (15) are coaches or managers with no committee role.

Presidents or chairpersons (22) and secretaries (20) together make up more than a third of all respondents. These are the people who usually carry the volunteer admin load and decide what tools the club uses.

Most respondents hold a committee or office-bearer role

Primary club role, each respondent counted once under the most senior role selected (Q2, n=122)



Respondents could select more than one role (1.8 on average). Coach / Manager was selected by 50 respondents in total, 35 of whom also held a committee or admin role.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q2, n=122

Chart 2: Primary club role (Q2)

Primary role	Count	%
Committee Member	23	18.9%
President / Chairperson	22	18.0%
Secretary	20	16.4%
Coach / Manager (only)	15	12.3%
Registrar / Administrator	11	9.0%
Volunteer Coordinator	11	9.0%
Treasurer	7	5.7%
Vice President	6	4.9%
Team / Age Coordinator	3	2.5%
Event Coordinator	2	1.6%
Other	2	1.6%

Table 1: Primary role of respondents (n=122)

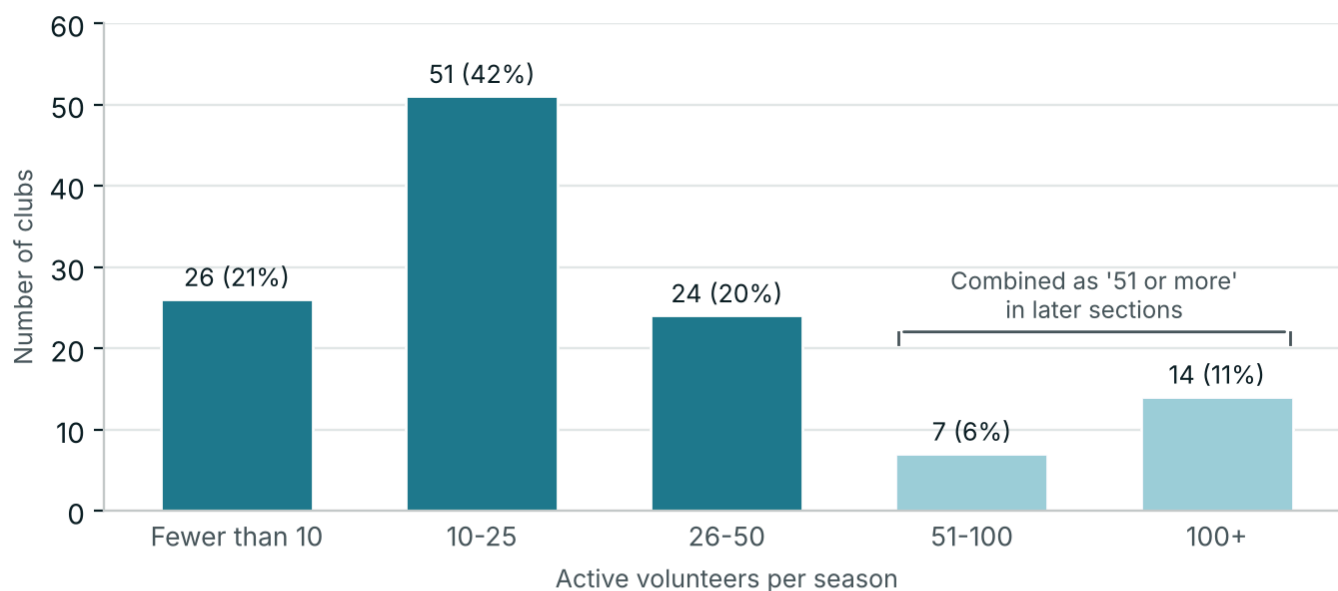
Note: Respondents could choose more than one role. On average each named 1.8 roles, and 40% (49 of 122) named more than one. Each respondent is counted once, under the most senior role they selected. Coach / Manager is ranked lowest because it is a team role, not a committee role. Coach / Manager was selected by 50 respondents (41%) in total, but 35 of them also held a committee or admin role. Write-ins were grouped as follows: "Coach" into Coach / Manager, and VP variants into Vice President. The 2 in Other are a technical director and a coach who also listed social media manager.

Club Size By Active Volunteers

Most clubs that responded run on a modest volunteer base. The most common size was 10-25 active volunteers a season (42%), and nearly two-thirds of clubs (63%) have 25 or fewer. One in six (17%) have more than 50, including 14 clubs (11%) with more than 100.

Nearly two-thirds of clubs run on 25 or fewer active volunteers

Approximate number of active volunteers or committee helpers each club relies on each season
(n=122)



Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q4, n=122

Chart 3: Active volunteers per season (Q4)

Active volunteers per season	Clubs	% of clubs
Fewer than 10	26	21.3%
10-25	51	41.8%
26-50	24	19.7%
51-100	7	5.7%
100+	14	11.5%

Table 2: Active volunteers per season (Q4, n=122)

Size bands used in this report. Wherever results are broken down by club size, the report uses four bands. The two largest Q4 groups are combined because 51-100 has only 7 responses, too few to report on its own.

Size band	Q4 answers included	n	% of respondents
Fewer than 10	Fewer than 10	26	21.3%
10-25	10-25	51	41.8%
26-50	26-50	24	19.7%
51 or more	51-100 and 100+	21	17.2%

Table 3: Size bands used in this report

Where the text describes clubs by size, "**small clubs**" means fewer than 10 volunteers, "**mid-sized clubs**" means 26-50, and "**large clubs**" means 51 or more. Band bases are small, so margins of error range from about ± 14 points (10-25, $n=51$) to about ± 21 points (51 or more, $n=21$). Treat differences between bands as indicative. Where it adds something, the two large-club groups are shown separately, for example in Challenges By Club Size (Table 16) and Club Size Against Weekly Admin Hours (Table 21).

Frequency Of Volunteer Need

Almost every club needs volunteers every week: 117 of 122 respondents (96%) chose "Weekly". The other five answered only for special events (2), fortnightly (1), monthly (1) and daily (1, written in under Other). This weekly group (Q6 = Weekly, $n=117$) is the base used for Challenges Among Weekly-Cadence Clubs (Table 17). There are only five non-weekly respondents, so Q10 time results are reported on all 122 respondents and are not filtered.

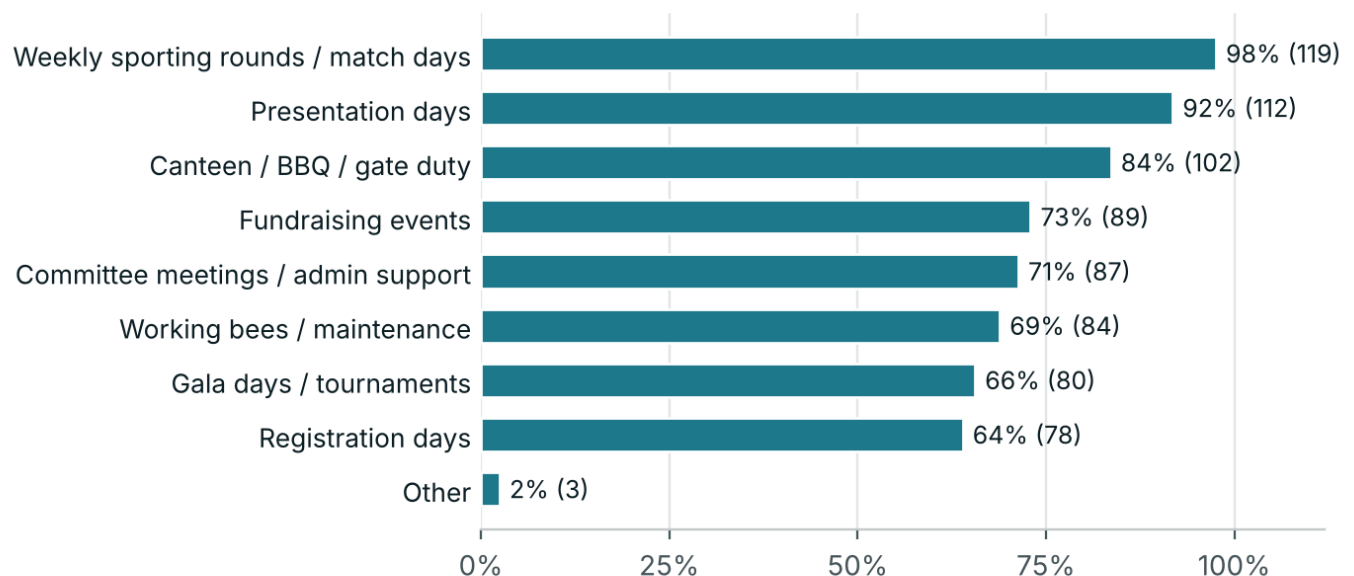
04 · THE SCALE OF THE VOLUNTEER BURDEN

Activities That Depend On Volunteers

Volunteers are not only needed on match day. Respondents ticked a median of 6 of the 8 listed activities as relying on volunteers (mean 6.2), and 58 of 122 (48%) ticked 7 or all 8. Weekly match days were close to universal at 98%, but more occasional activities were also common. More than nine in ten clubs need volunteers for presentation days, and around two-thirds need them for gala days, working bees and registration days.

Volunteers are needed well beyond match day

Club activities that rely on volunteers or staffing (Q5, n=122, select all that apply)



Respondents ticked a median of 6 of the 8 listed activities. 'Other' covers media/marketing, social media and net duty.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q5, n=122

Chart 4: Activities that rely on volunteers (Q5)

Activity	Clubs	%
Weekly sporting rounds / match days	119	98%
Presentation days	112	92%
Canteen / BBQ / gate duty	102	84%
Fundraising events	89	73%
Committee meetings / admin support	87	71%
Working bees / maintenance	84	69%
Gala days / tournaments	80	66%
Registration days	78	64%
Other (media/marketing, social media, net duty)	3	2%

Table 4: Activities that rely on volunteers (Q5, n=122, multi-select)

Size band	n	Median activities	Mean
Fewer than 10	26	7	6.3
10-25	51	7	6.3
26-50	24	6	6.3
51+	21	5	5.5

Table 5: Activities by size band (Q4, active volunteers per season)

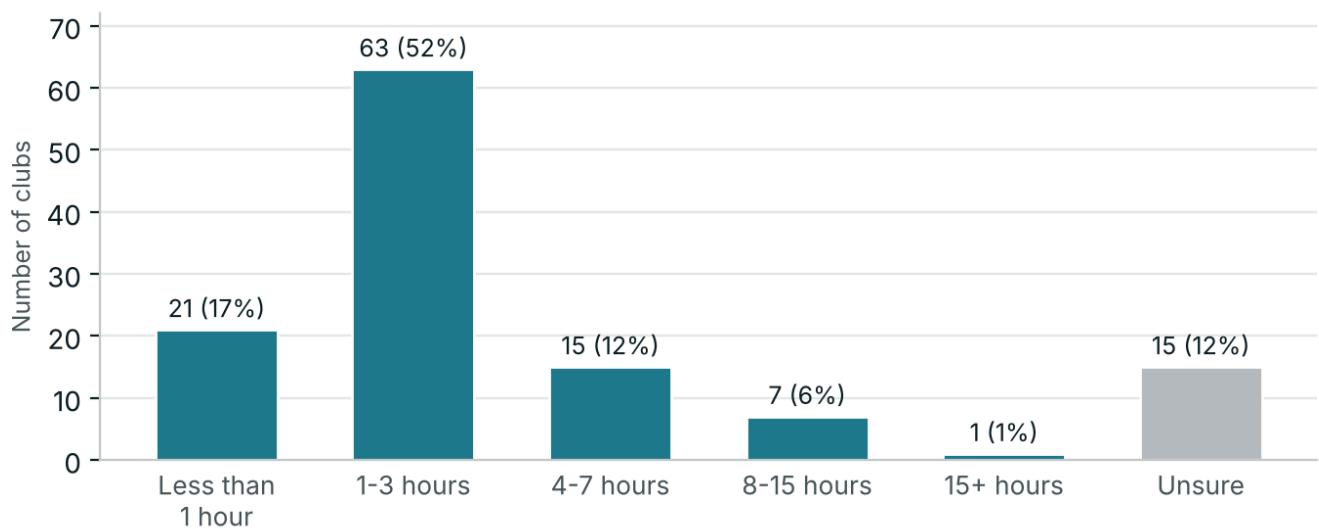
The number of activities stays about the same from the smallest clubs up to 50 volunteers. Clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers have the same spread of activities to cover as clubs with five times as many people, so the work falls on fewer people. The 51+ band reports fewer activities, mainly because fewer of them ticked registration days (38% against about 70% elsewhere) and presentation days (76% against about 95%). A likely reason is that larger clubs hand some functions to staff or online systems, or that people answering for large clubs only see their own part of the operation.

Weekly Time Spent Coordinating Volunteers

Most clubs spend 1-3 hours a week just organising volunteers (52% of all respondents). One in five clubs that gave an estimate (21%) spend 4 hours or more. 12% were unsure, which suggests the work is spread across people and not tracked.

Most clubs spend 1-3 hours a week organising volunteers

Time spent organising volunteers in a typical week (Q10, n=122)



12% were unsure. Of the 107 who gave an estimate, 21% spend 4 hours or more a week.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q10, n=122

Chart 5: Weekly time spent coordinating volunteers (Q10)

Weekly time	Clubs	% of all	% of those who estimated (n = 107)
Less than 1 hour	21	17%	20%
1-3 hours	63	52%	59%
4-7 hours	15	12%	14%
8-15 hours	7	6%	7%
15+ hours	1	1%	1%
Unsure	15	12%	-

Table 6: Weekly coordination time (Q10, n=122)

The time rises with club size. Among clubs that gave an estimate, the share spending 4+ hours a week climbs from 12% (fewer than 10 volunteers) to 20% (10-25), 22% (26-50) and 37% (51+).

What This Adds Up To Across A Season

Each band was converted to its midpoint (<1 hr = 0.5, 1-3 = 2, 4-7 = 5.5, 8-15 = 11.5, 15+ = 15 as a conservative floor) and multiplied by a 20-week season. That covers a typical grassroots competition of about 18 rounds plus grading. Unsure responses are left out.

Club size	n	Avg hrs/week	Avg hrs/season	Median hrs/season
All clubs	107	2.9	59	40
Fewer than 10	25	2.2	45	40
10-25	45	2.7	53	40
26-50	18	2.9	59	40
51+	19	4.5	90	40

Table 7: Estimated coordination hours per season

A typical club spends about 40-60 volunteer hours a season just organising volunteers, before anyone does a duty. That is roughly one and a half standard working weeks of unpaid admin. For clubs with 51+ volunteers the average rises to about 90 hours, or more than two working weeks. The median is the same 40 hours in every band, so the higher averages come from a minority of clubs with a much heavier load, not from every club.

Together, the 107 respondents that gave an estimate account for about 6,300 hours of coordination admin a season.

These figures are likely to understate the real load. The 20-week window only covers the competition season. Many clubs also need volunteers before and after it, for example:

- Registration days
- Pre-season trials and grading
- Working bees to get grounds ready
- Presentation days
- End-of-season fundraisers
- Summer gala days and tournaments

Q5 shows how common these are (Table 4): 92% of clubs need volunteers for presentation days, 66% for gala days and tournaments, and 64% for registration days. Each of these events takes its own round of coordination. If the coordination period runs to 26 weeks, the average rises to about 76 hours a season (median 52), and at 30 weeks it reaches about 88 hours (median 60).

Notes on method: results are per respondent, not per club. Some clubs answered more than once, so the combined total overstates the number of distinct clubs. Midpoints are estimates, and setting 15+ to 20 hours moves the overall average by less than 0.1 hours a week.

05 · HOW CLUBS CURRENTLY COORDINATE VOLUNTEERS

Grassroots football clubs coordinate volunteers mostly with everyday messaging apps and spreadsheets. On average they spread this work across 2.6 separate tools and channels per club, and only 6% use software built for rostering.

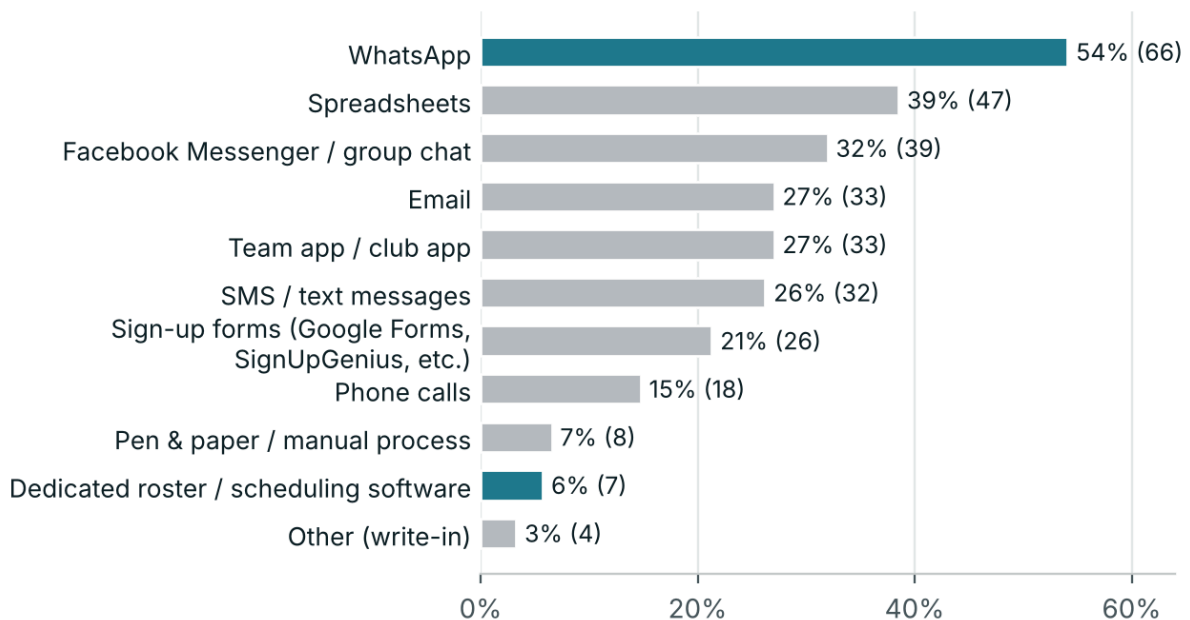
Base: Q7 was "select all that apply", so adoption figures add up to more than 100%.

Tools And Channels In Use

WhatsApp is the default coordination channel, used by 66 of 122 respondents (54%). Spreadsheets come next (39%), then Facebook Messenger (32%).

WhatsApp is used by 54% of clubs; dedicated rostering software by 6%

Share of clubs using each tool to organise volunteers and duty rosters (n=122, select all that apply)



Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q7, n=122

Chart 6: Tool adoption (Q7)

Tool / channel	Clubs	% of clubs
WhatsApp	66	54.1%
Spreadsheets	47	38.5%
Facebook Messenger / group chat	39	32.0%
Email	33	27.0%
Team app / club app	33	27.0%
SMS / text messages	32	26.2%
Sign-up forms (Google Forms, SignUpGenius, etc.)	26	21.3%
Phone calls	18	14.8%
Pen & paper / manual process	8	6.6%
Dedicated roster / scheduling software	7	5.7%
Other (write-in)	4	3.3%

Table 8: Tool and channel adoption (Q7, n=122, select all that apply)

Four in five clubs (80%) use at least one chat channel: WhatsApp, Messenger or SMS. More than half (57%) use no structured tool at all, meaning no team app, no sign-up form and no dedicated rostering software.

Purpose-built rostering software is close to absent. Only 7 clubs (6%) use it, and just 2 of them use it on its own. The other 5 still run it alongside chat, spreadsheets or a team app.

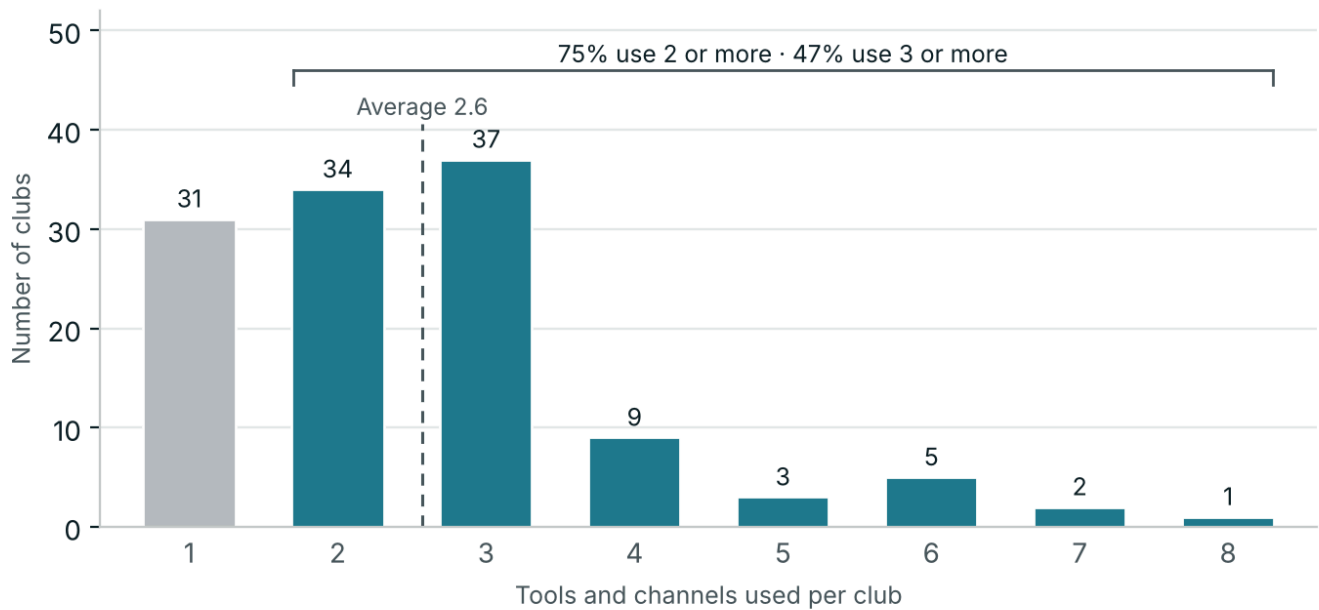
The four write-ins named Spond, 360Player and a club-built system called Club Deck. The fourth simply said "Begging whenever we see people."

The Fragmentation Problem

The average club coordinates volunteers across 2.6 separate tools and channels (median 2). Three in four clubs (75%) use two or more, and nearly half (47%) use three or more.

Three in four clubs juggle two or more channels, 2.6 on average

Number of clubs by how many tools and channels they use to coordinate volunteers (n=122)



Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q7 (count of options ticked per respondent), n=122

Chart 7: Number of tools and channels per club (Q7)

Tools / channel used	Clubs	% of clubs
1	31	25.4%
2	34	27.9%
3	37	30.3%
4	9	7.4%
5	3	2.5%
6	5	4.1%
7	2	1.6%
8	1	0.8%
Average	2.57	
Median	2	

Table 9: Number of tools and channels per club (Q7, n=122)

The most common pattern pairs a planning tool with a chat channel. 28% of clubs combine a spreadsheet with WhatsApp, Messenger or SMS, so the roster lives in one place while reminders and swaps happen in another.

At the far end, 11 clubs (9%) run five or more channels at once. Using a single channel doesn't mean a club has solved the problem either: 18 of the 31 single-channel clubs run everything through WhatsApp alone.

Fragmentation is highest in mid-sized clubs. Clubs with 26-50 volunteers average 3.3 channels, and 71% of them use three or more.

Active volunteers per season	Clubs (n)	Avg channels	% using 3+ channels
Fewer than 10	26	2.3	27%
10-25	51	2.4	45%
26-50	24	3.3	71%
51 or more	21	2.5	48%

Table 10: Channels by club size

Each option ticked counts as one channel, including write-ins.

How Duties Get Assigned

Most clubs fill duties with a mix of committee assignment and volunteers putting their hand up (38%), or with volunteers nominating themselves (29%). Only 14% have the committee assign duties outright.

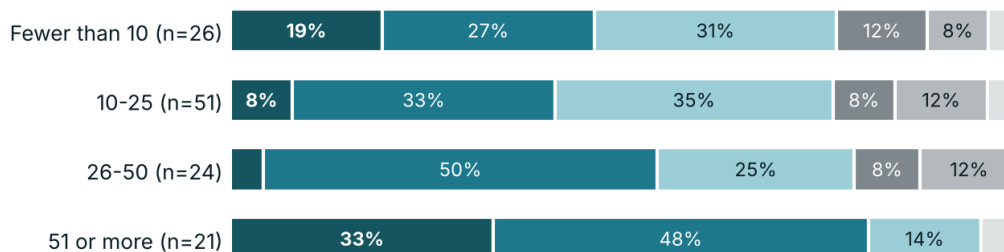
Committee assignment jumps to 33% in clubs with 51+ volunteers, vs 10% in smaller clubs

How volunteers are usually assigned to duties, share of clubs

Committee assigns
Mix of both
Volunteers self-nominate
Depends on the event
Mostly informal / ad hoc
Other



By active volunteers per season



51-100 (n=7) and 100+ (n=14) combined as '51 or more'. Segments under 7% are unlabelled; see Table 12.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q8 by Q4, n=122

Chart 8: How duties get assigned by size band (Q8 × Q4)

Assignment method	Clubs	% of clubs
A mix of assigning and self-selection	46	37.7%
Volunteers nominate themselves	35	28.7%
Committee manually assigns people	17	13.9%
Mostly informal / ad hoc	11	9.0%
Depends on the event	9	7.4%
Other (write-in)	4	3.3%

Table 11: Assignment method, all clubs (Q8, n=122)

Active volunteers	n	Committee assigns	Mix of both	Self-nominate	Depends on event	Informal / ad hoc	Other
Fewer than 10	26	19.2% (5)	26.9% (7)	30.8% (8)	11.5% (3)	7.7% (2)	3.8% (1)
10-25	51	7.8% (4)	33.3% (17)	35.3% (18)	7.8% (4)	11.8% (6)	3.9% (2)
26-50	24	4.2% (1)	50.0% (12)	25.0% (6)	8.3% (2)	12.5% (3)	0.0% (0)
51 or more	21	33.3% (7)	47.6% (10)	14.3% (3)	0.0% (0)	0.0% (0)	4.8% (1)

Table 12: Assignment method by club size (Q8 × Q4, % of clubs in each band, count in brackets)

No single model dominates, and the mix changes with size. In clubs with 51 or more volunteers, a third (33%) have the committee assign duties, compared with 10% of smaller clubs.

Self-nomination falls from 35% in clubs with 10-25 volunteers to 14% in clubs with 51 or more.

Clubs with 26-50 volunteers are the most likely to mix assignment and self-selection (50%), and they are also the most fragmented (3.3 channels on average). Running two models side by side seems to add tools: clubs where volunteers self-nominate average 2.1 channels, against 3.6 where it "depends on the event".

The four "Other" write-ins describe team-based quotas, such as each team supplying four helpers for home games, or club-wide call-outs that few people answer, leaving committee members and their families to cover the gaps.

06 · THE BIGGEST CHALLENGES CLUBS FACE

Respondents were asked to pick the three biggest challenges their club faces when organising volunteers (Q9). All 122 respondents answered. The answers show one dominant problem: there aren't enough volunteers, and the work falls on the same few people. Operational issues such as no-shows, chasing confirmations and availability come well behind. Admin problems, like building rosters, tracking contributions and juggling tools, barely register as a headline pain.

Methodology note: Q9 asked for the "top 3" but the form didn't enforce it. 84 respondents picked exactly three, 29 picked one or two, and 9 picked four or more. Percentages throughout are % of respondents who selected each challenge, so totals add to more than 100%. The base is all 122 respondents. Removing the 7 who answered "No" to Q1 changes no figure by more than one percentage point. There was one "Other" write-in ("lack of communication").

Ranking The Top Challenges

Two challenges were named by nine in ten clubs: finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping, each selected by 110 respondents (90%). They're really one problem seen from two sides. 100 respondents (82%) picked both, and 120 of 122 (98%) picked at least one. The volunteer pool is too small, so a dedicated core ends up carrying the load.

Volunteer burnout came third at 40%. That's the cost of the first two. 40 respondents (33%) picked the full set of finding volunteers, same people helping and burnout. That was the most common answer pattern in the survey.

After those three, the ranking moves into reliability problems on the day:

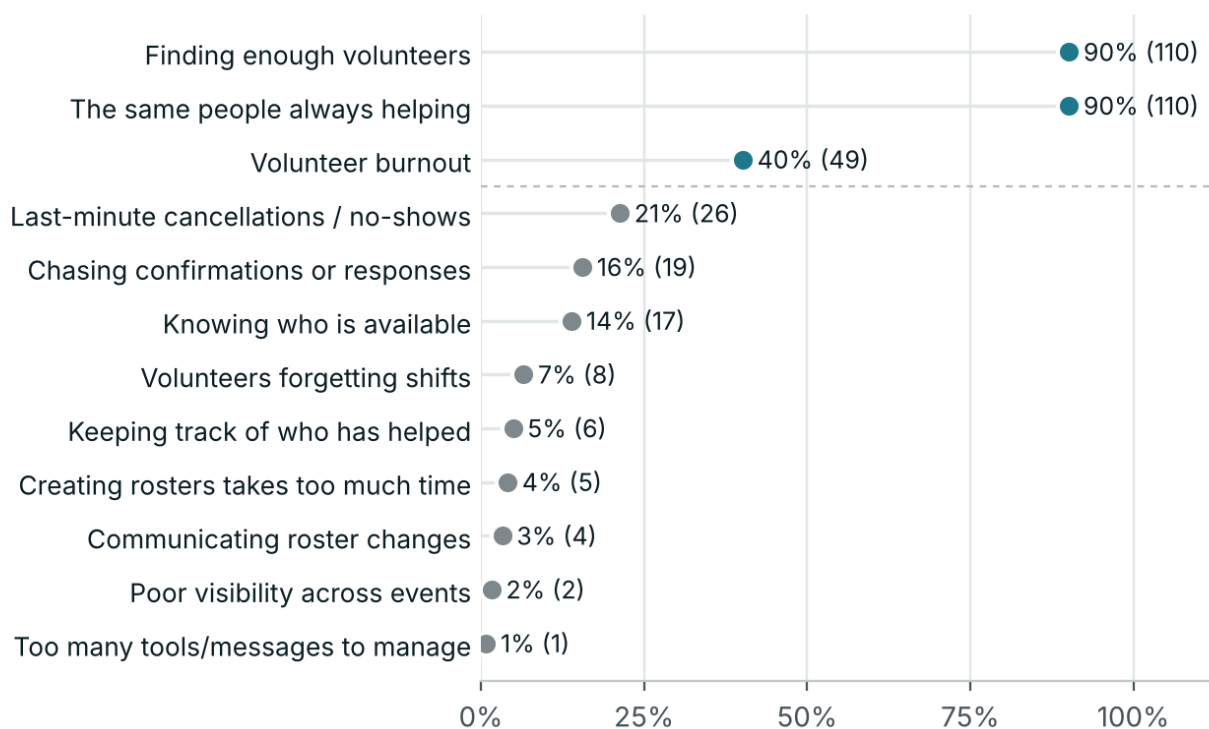
- Last-minute cancellations and no-shows (21%)
- Chasing confirmations (16%)
- Knowing who is available (14%)

37% of respondents named at least one of no-shows, chasing confirmations or forgotten shifts. Just over half (52%) named at least one operational or admin challenge of any kind alongside the supply problem.

Pure admin problems ranked at the bottom. Roster-building time (4%), tracking who has helped (5%), communicating roster changes (3%) and too many tools or messages (1%) were rarely chosen. Committees don't see the paperwork as their main problem. They see the shortage of people as the problem, and admin as how that shortage shows up week to week.

Two challenges dominate: finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping

Q9 - Respondents were asked to select their top three. n = 122.



Percentages sum to more than 100%. 9 respondents selected more than three options.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q9, n=122

Chart 9: Biggest challenges organising volunteers

Rank	Challenge	n	% of respondents
1=	Finding enough volunteers	110	90.2%
1=	The same people always helping	110	90.2%
3	Volunteer burnout	49	40.2%
4	Last-minute cancellations / no-shows	26	21.3%
5	Chasing confirmations or responses	19	15.6%
6	Knowing who is available	17	13.9%
7	Volunteers forgetting shifts	8	6.6%
8	Keeping track of who has helped	6	4.9%
9	Creating rosters takes too much time	5	4.1%
10	Communicating roster changes	4	3.3%
11	Poor visibility across events	2	1.6%
12	Too many tools/messages to manage	1	0.8%
-	Other ("lack of communication")	1	0.8%

Table 13: Q9 challenges, all respondents (n = 122)

Metric	n	%
Named both "finding enough" and "same people"	100	82%
Named at least one of those two	120	98%
Named finding + same people + burnout together	40	33%
Named a reliability issue (no-shows / chasing / forgetting)	45	37%
Named any operational or admin challenge (options 4-12)	63	52%

Table 14: How the top challenges overlap

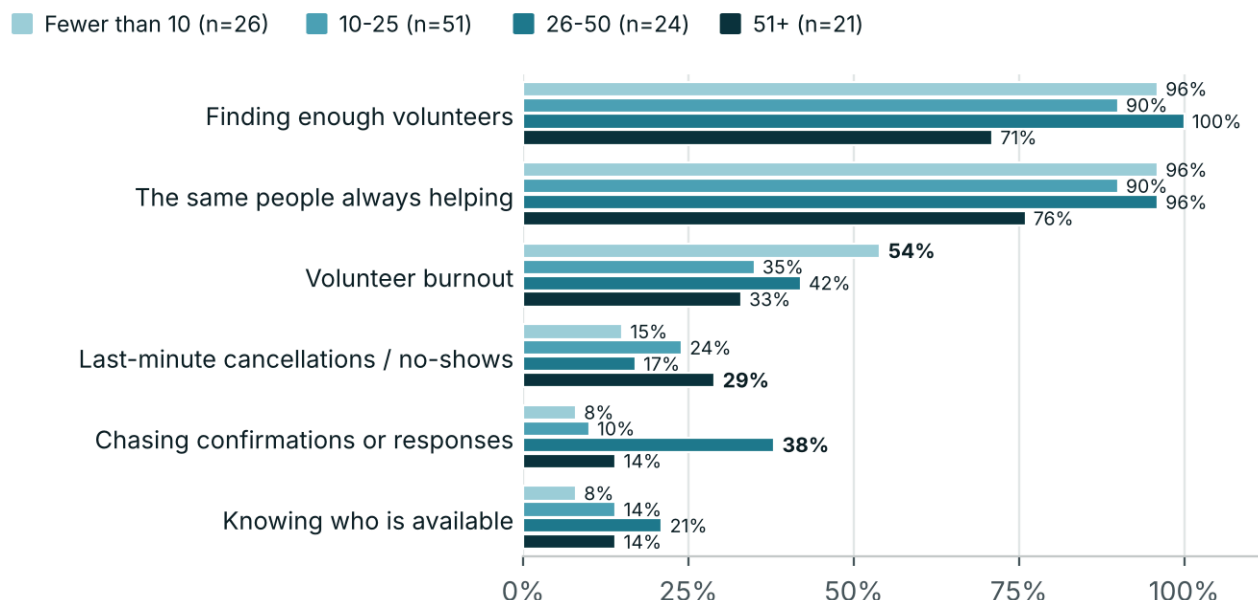
Challenges By Club Size

Club size (Q4) changes the mix of challenges, though not which ones lead.

- **Small clubs (fewer than 10 volunteers)** feel the supply problem most: 96% named finding volunteers and 96% the same people helping. Burnout is highest here at 54%. When a handful of people run the whole club, burnout is close to inevitable.
- **Clubs with 10-25 and 26-50 volunteers** look like the overall picture. 26-50 clubs stand out on chasing confirmations (38%, more than double any other band) and knowing who is available (21%).
- **Larger clubs (51+ volunteers)** report the supply problem less often (71% and 76%, against 90%+ elsewhere), but no-shows more often (29%). The issue moves from finding people to making sure they turn up. Clubs with 100+ volunteers alone had the highest no-show rate in the survey (36%, 5 of 14).

Small clubs burn out; mid-sized clubs chase confirmations

Q9 by Q4 (active volunteers per season). Respondents selected their top three.



51-100 and 100+ combined due to small base (n = 7 and n = 14). Highlighted values are called out in the text.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q9 by Q4, n=122

Chart 10: Top six challenges by club size

Challenge	Fewer than 10 (n=26)	10-25 (n=51)	26-50 (n=24)	51+ (n=21)	All (n=122)
Finding enough volunteers	96% (25)	90% (46)	100% (24)	71% (15)	90%
The same people always helping	96% (25)	90% (46)	96% (23)	76% (16)	90%
Volunteer burnout	54% (14)	35% (18)	42% (10)	33% (7)	40%
Last-minute cancellations / no-shows	15% (4)	24% (12)	17% (4)	29% (6)	21%
Chasing confirmations or responses	8% (2)	10% (5)	38% (9)	14% (3)	16%
Knowing who is available	8% (2)	14% (7)	21% (5)	14% (3)	14%

Table 15: Top six challenges by club size (% of band, n in brackets)

Table 16 shows the 51-100 and 100+ bands separately.

Challenge	51-100 (n=7)	100+ (n=14)
Finding enough volunteers	86% (6)	64% (9)
The same people always helping	71% (5)	79% (11)
Volunteer burnout	57% (4)	21% (3)
Last-minute cancellations / no-shows	14% (1)	36% (5)
Chasing confirmations or responses	0% (0)	21% (3)
Knowing who is available	0% (0)	21% (3)
Keeping track of who has helped	29% (2)	14% (2)

Table 16: Unmerged large-club bands

Challenges Among Weekly-Cadence Clubs

Almost every club in the sample needs volunteers every week. 117 of 122 respondents (96%) chose "Weekly" for Q6. Grassroots football runs on a fixed weekly fixture cycle, so the roster problem comes back every week of the season.

Among weekly-cadence clubs, the ranking is the same as overall:

- Finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping (both 90%)
- Burnout (39%)
- No-shows (21%)
- Chasing confirmations (16%)
- Knowing who is available (14%)

The point isn't that weekly clubs differ. It's that the challenges above repeat every week. Every week, a coordinator has to find people, lean on the same reliable few, chase replies and cover no-shows, across a season of about 18 rounds plus grading. 42 weekly clubs (36%) named at least one reliability issue (no-shows, chasing or forgotten shifts) on top of the supply problem.

Within weekly clubs, people who organise volunteers themselves (Q1 = regularly or occasionally, n = 80) report the operational problems a little more often than those in leadership-only roles (n = 30):

- Chasing confirmations: 18% vs 13%
- Knowing who is available: 15% vs 10%
- No-shows: 21% vs 17%
- Tracking who has helped: 6% vs 0%

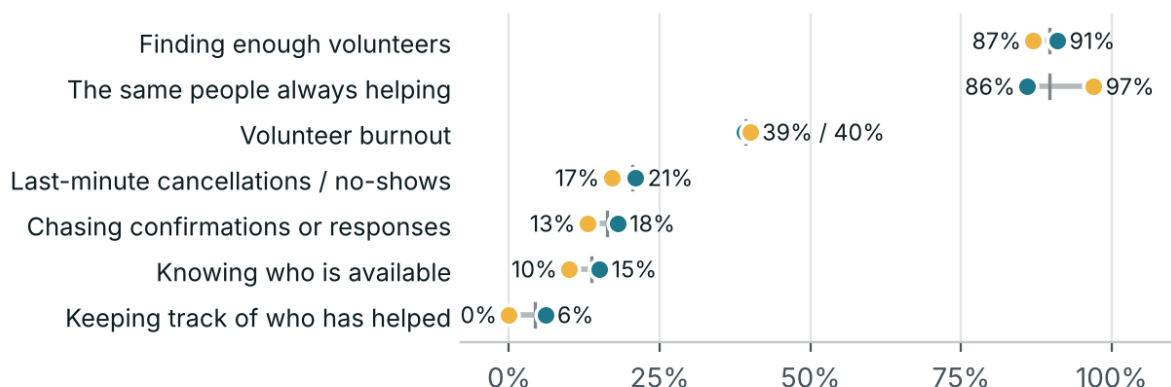
Leadership-only respondents were more likely to name "the same people always helping" (97% vs 86%). The people doing the rostering see the weekly admin. The wider committee mainly sees the pattern of who turns up.

Data note: Only 5 respondents were not weekly (see Frequency Of Volunteer Need). That's too few for a weekly vs non-weekly comparison, so this section reports the weekly group on its own and uses the coordinator vs leadership split as the comparison.

Coordinators report slightly more of the weekly admin problems

Weekly-cadence clubs (Q6 = Weekly, n=117), split by Q1 role. Top-three challenges (Q9).

■ Coordinators (n=80) ■ Leadership-only (n=30) ■ Weekly total (n=117)



7 weekly respondents who answered 'No' to Q1 are in the total but in neither group.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q9 by Q6 and Q1, n=117

Chart 11: Challenges among weekly-cadence clubs, coordinators vs leadership

Challenge	Weekly total (n=117)	Coordinators (n=80)	Leadership-only (n=30)
Finding enough volunteers	89.7% (105)	91% (73)	87% (26)
The same people always helping	89.7% (105)	86% (69)	97% (29)
Volunteer burnout	39.3% (46)	39% (31)	40% (12)
Last-minute cancellations / no-shows	20.5% (24)	21% (17)	17% (5)
Chasing confirmations or responses	16.2% (19)	18% (14)	13% (4)
Knowing who is available	13.7% (16)	15% (12)	10% (3)
Keeping track of who has helped	4.3% (5)	6% (5)	0% (0)
Volunteers forgetting shifts	4.3% (5)	5% (4)	3% (1)
Creating rosters takes too much time	4.3% (5)	5% (4)	3% (1)
Communicating roster changes	3.4% (4)	4% (3)	3% (1)

Table 17: Q9 among weekly-cadence clubs (Q6 = Weekly)

07 · WHERE THE PATTERNS CONNECT

The earlier sections look at each question on its own. This section puts questions side by side to see whether the way a club works (how many tools it uses, how big it is, how it assigns duties) changes the problems it reports and the time it spends.

The short answer is that the obvious links mostly aren't there, and that tells us something too. Using more tools doesn't change the admin challenges clubs report, but it does go with much higher burnout. Bigger clubs spend more hours in total, but small clubs spend far more time per volunteer. And no way of assigning duties stops no-shows. Each method just moves the work somewhere else.

Data note: These are cross-tabulations of subgroups, so the bases are smaller than in earlier sections and the margins of error are wider (about ± 12 to ± 22 points for groups of 20 to 65). Only differences of 15 points or more are called out as findings. All of these are associations, not proof of cause. Size bands are the same as earlier: 51-100 and 100+ are combined as "51 or more". Hours use the band midpoints from "What This Adds Up To Across A Season" (Table 7), and "Unsure" is excluded from the averages.

Tool Count Against Challenge Count

Clubs that use more tools don't report more challenges. The average number of Q9 challenges is about the same whether a club uses one channel (2.7) or four or more (2.9). The admin challenges you might expect fragmentation to cause, such as knowing who is available, tracking who has helped or communicating roster changes, also show no pattern. Only one respondent in the whole survey picked "Too many tools/messages to manage", and that person's club uses three.

What does change with tool count is burnout. Among clubs using three or more channels, 51% named volunteer burnout as a top-three challenge. Among clubs using one or two, 31% did. The gap shows up in responses from both forms, though it is smaller among the 94 who used the website form (38% vs 28%). It isn't just a club-size effect either. It holds in three of the four size bands:

- Fewer than 10 volunteers: 47% → 71%
- 10-25 volunteers: 21% → 52%
- 51 or more volunteers: 18% → 50%
- 26-50 volunteers: flat (43% → 41%)

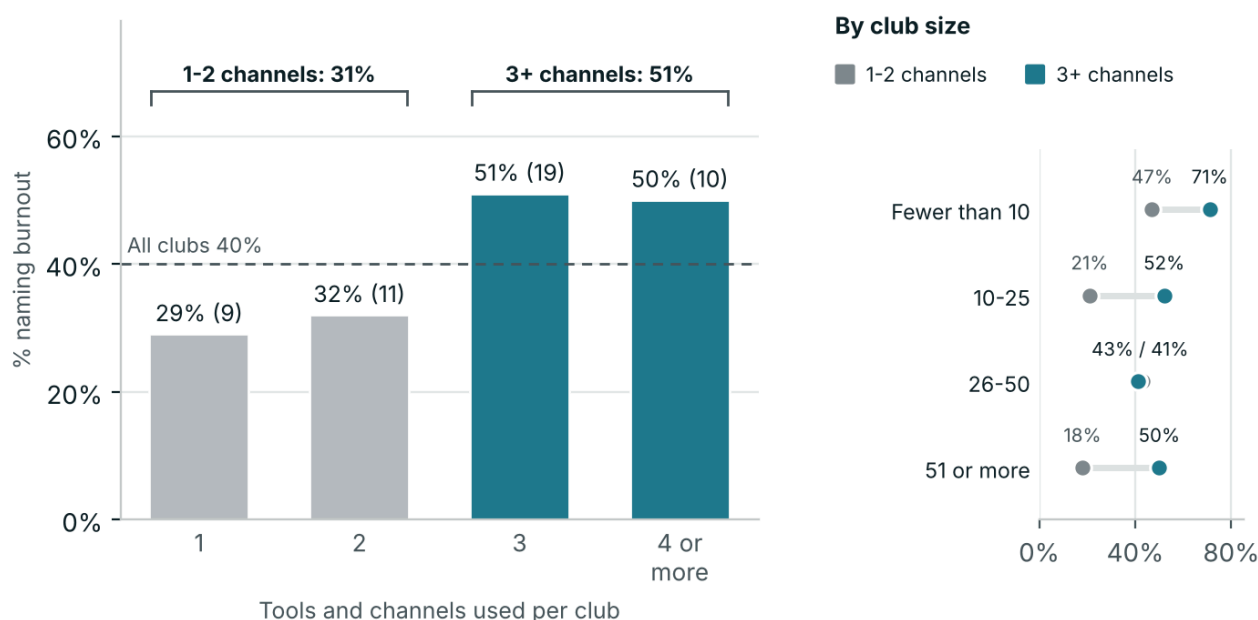
Clubs with more channels are also more likely to say they don't know how long coordination takes. 19% of clubs using three or more channels answered "Unsure" to Q10, compared with 6% of clubs using one or two. When the roster sits in a spreadsheet, reminders go out on WhatsApp and swaps happen over SMS, nobody can see the whole workload, including the people doing it.

The link to hours is weak. Average weekly hours are about the same across tool bands (2.7-3.2 hours). The share spending 4+ hours a week rises from 17% of single-channel clubs to 33% of clubs using four or more channels (n = 18).

How to read this: Committees don't name fragmentation as a problem. They don't think "we have too many tools". They report it as people being worn out. The link may run either way. Stretched clubs may add channels to reach more people, or juggling channels may wear people down. Either way, fragmentation and burnout go together, and the extra workload is mostly hidden.

Half of clubs juggling three or more channels report burnout, against under a third of the rest

Share of clubs naming volunteer burnout as a top-three challenge, by number of tools and channels used (n=122)



Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q7 by Q9, n=122

Chart 12: Volunteer burnout by number of tools and channels (Q9 × Q7)

Measure	1 channel	2 channels	3 channels	4 or more	All clubs
Clubs (n)	31	34	37	20	122
Avg challenges named	2.7	2.7	3.3	2.9	2.9
Volunteer burnout	29% (9)	32% (11)	51% (19)	50% (10)	40% (49)
No-shows	13% (4)	29% (10)	22% (8)	20% (4)	21% (26)
Chasing confirmations	16% (5)	9% (3)	22% (8)	15% (3)	16% (19)
Any reliability issue ¹	35% (11)	41% (14)	35% (13)	35% (7)	37% (45)
Any admin issue ²	26% (8)	15% (5)	32% (12)	15% (3)	23% (28)
"Unsure" of weekly time	3% (1)	9% (3)	24% (9)	10% (2)	12% (15)
Avg hrs/week (n estimating)	2.9 (30)	3.2 (31)	2.7 (28)	2.9 (18)	2.9 (107)
4+ hrs/week	17% (5)	19% (6)	21% (6)	33% (6)	21% (23)

Table 18: Challenges and time by number of tools and channels (Q7 × Q9 × Q10)

¹ No-shows, chasing confirmations or volunteers forgetting shifts.

² Knowing who is available, tracking who has helped, creating rosters, communicating roster changes, poor visibility across events, or too many tools/messages.

Active volunteers	1-2 channels	3+ channels	Gap
Fewer than 10	47% (9 of 19)	71% (5 of 7)	+24 pts
10-25	21% (6 of 28)	52% (12 of 23)	+31 pts
26-50	43% (3 of 7)	41% (7 of 17)	-2 pts
51 or more	18% (2 of 11)	50% (5 of 10)	+32 pts
All clubs	31% (20 of 65)	51% (29 of 57)	+20 pts

Table 19: Burnout by size band and channel count

Note on challenge count: Q9 asked for the top three, and 84 respondents picked exactly three, so the number of challenges named can't really measure how much pain a club is in. It's reported for completeness. Of the 9 respondents who picked four or more challenges, 7 use three or more channels.

Club Size Against Weekly Admin Hours

Bigger clubs spend more time coordinating volunteers, but not by much. Average weekly hours rise from 2.2 in clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers to 4.5 in clubs with 51 or more. The median is 1-3 hours (midpoint 2) in every band. The link between size and hours is real but weak. Most of the rise comes from a minority of large clubs with a very heavy load.

Clubs with 51 or more volunteers are split. 37% of those that gave an estimate spend 4+ hours a week, including the only 15+ hour response in the survey (a 100+ club). Another 16% spend under an hour. Large clubs seem to fall into two groups: those with a dedicated coordinator carrying a big load, and those that have handed the work to teams, staff or systems. This fits the Q5 finding that 51+ clubs ticked fewer activities (Table 5), and the Q8 finding that a third of them have the committee assign duties (Table 12).

Per volunteer, the picture flips. Club size grows much faster than admin time. A club with fewer than 10 volunteers spends about 19 minutes of coordination a week for each volunteer. A club with 100+ spends about 2 minutes. That's roughly an eight-fold difference in admin per head.

This is where the earlier findings meet:

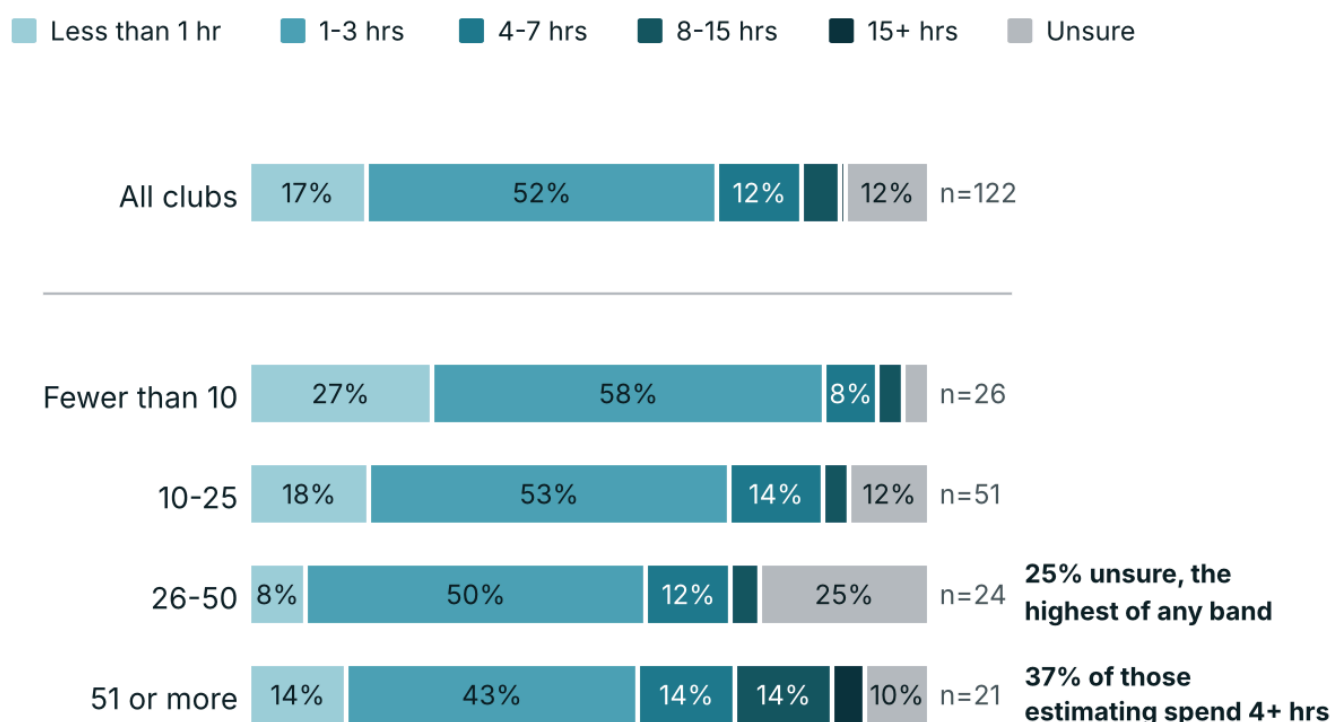
- Small clubs cover nearly the same spread of activities as clubs five times their size (median 7, Table 5).
- They report the highest burnout of any band (54%, Table 15).
- They report the lowest total hours (2.2 a week).

Small clubs don't burn out because coordination takes many hours. They burn out because the same handful of people do the coordinating and the duties, every week. The 2.2 hours sit on top of turning up to do the canteen shift.

Clubs with 26-50 volunteers are the least sure of their workload: 25% answered "Unsure". They're also the most fragmented band (3.3 channels on average, 71% using three or more) and the band most likely to name chasing confirmations (38%). This mid-sized band keeps standing out. These clubs have outgrown informal coordination but haven't moved to a structured system, so the work is spread out and hard to see.

Total hours rise with club size, but the typical club spends 1-3 hours a week at every size

Time spent organising volunteers in a typical week, by active volunteers per season (n=122)



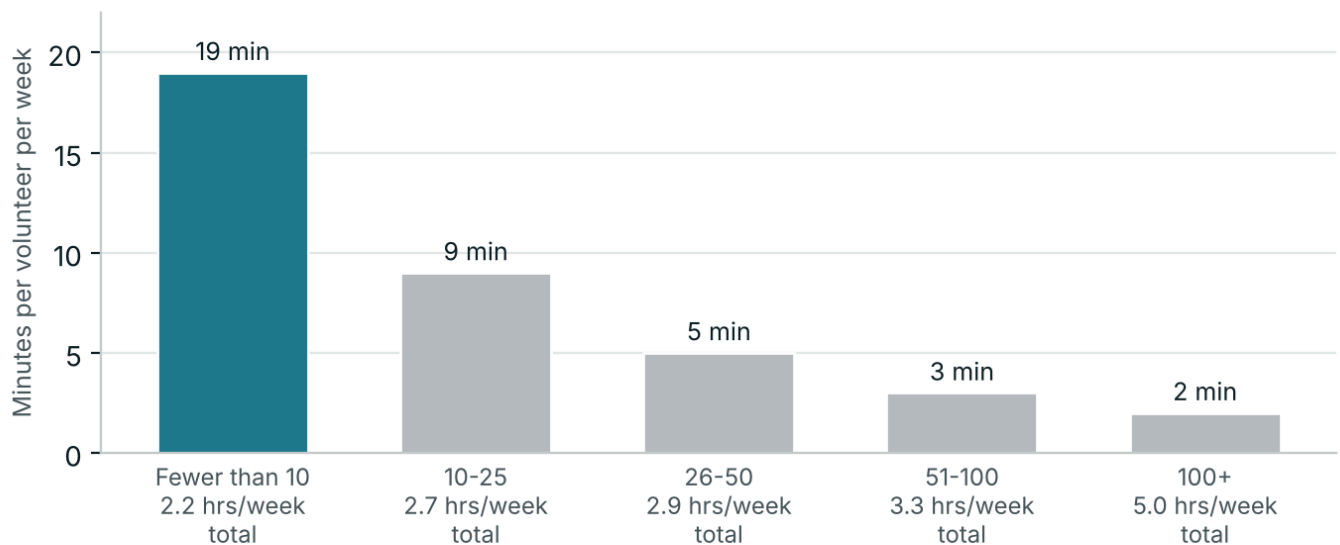
Segments under 7% are unlabelled; see Table 20.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q10 by Q4, n=122

Chart 13: Weekly coordination time by club size (Q10 × Q4)

Small clubs spend about 8× more coordination time per volunteer than the largest clubs

Estimated weekly coordination minutes per active volunteer, by club size (clubs that gave an estimate, n=107)



Derived using band midpoints for both hours and volunteer count (Fewer than 10 = 7; 100+ = 125 as a conservative value). Indicative only. 51-100 has n = 6.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q4 and Q10 (derived), n=107

Chart 14: Coordination minutes per volunteer per week (Q10 ÷ Q4, derived)

Weekly time	Fewer than 10	10-25	26-50	51 or more	All clubs
Clubs (n)	26	51	24	21	122
Less than 1 hr	7	9	2	3	21
1-3 hrs	15	27	12	9	63
4-7 hrs	2	7	3	3	15
8-15 hrs	1	2	1	3	7
15+ hrs	0	0	0	1	1
Unsure	1 (4%)	6 (12%)	6 (25%)	2 (10%)	15 (12%)
4+ hrs (of those estimating)	12% (3 of 25)	20% (9 of 45)	22% (4 of 18)	37% (7 of 19)	21% (23 of 107)
Avg hrs/week	2.2	2.7	2.9	4.5	2.9
Median hrs/week	2	2	2	2	2

Table 20: Weekly coordination time by club size (count of clubs)

Active volunteers	n estimating	Avg hrs/week	Assumed volunteers (midpoint)	Minutes per volunteer per week
Fewer than 10	25	2.2	7	19
10-25	45	2.7	17.5	9
26-50	18	2.9	38	5
51-100	6	3.3	75	3
100+	13	5.0	125	2

Table 21: Time per volunteer (derived, unmerged bands)

Note: The per-volunteer figures depend on the midpoints chosen and should be read as orders of magnitude, not exact values. The direction holds under any reasonable choice of midpoints.

Admin time weighs differently depending on club size. In large clubs it's a total-hours load, often carried by one or two coordinators. In small clubs it's a load per person, because the few people running the club are also its volunteers. Mid-sized clubs (26-50) use the most channels, are the most likely to name chasing confirmations, and are the least able to say how long coordination takes.

Assignment Method Against No-Shows And Cancellations

No assignment method prevents no-shows. Last-minute cancellations and no-shows were named by 24% of clubs where the committee assigns duties, 26% where it's a mix, and 20% where volunteers nominate themselves. The differences are well within the margin of error. More broadly, 37-41% of clubs using any of the three main methods named at least one reliability issue (no-shows, chasing confirmations or forgotten shifts). Whether people are told to turn up or offer to, the same share don't.

The only lower figure is clubs that run things informally or ad hoc (9%, 1 of 11). That isn't because informal coordination works better. If nobody is formally rostered, nobody can technically no-show. Instead, every one of those 11 clubs named "finding enough volunteers", and they spend 3.6 hours a week on average, above the overall 2.9. The problem shows up as a shortage before the day, not as a gap on the day.

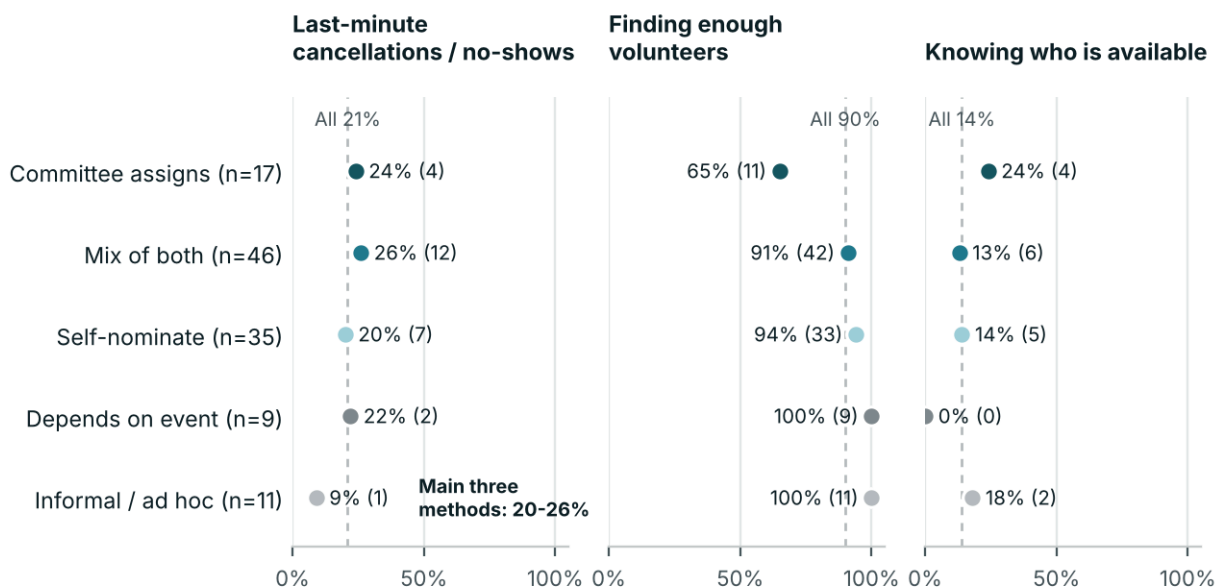
What assignment method does change is where the effort goes:

- Committee assigns (n=17): These clubs are much less likely to name finding enough volunteers (65%, against 91-100% for every other method) and the least likely to name burnout (29%). The cost shows up elsewhere. They're the most likely to struggle with knowing who is available (24%, against 13-14% for mix and self-nomination), and they spend more time: 3.7 hours a week against 2.6-2.7. Assigning duties takes the uncertainty out of supply but makes the committee responsible for availability and follow-up. The pattern holds when 51+ clubs are taken out (finding volunteers 70%, burnout 20%, n=10).
- Mix of both (n=46): These clubs have the highest burnout of the main methods (50%) and the highest no-show rate (26%). Running two models side by side seems to bring the downsides of both.

- Volunteers self-nominate (n=35): This is the cheapest method in time (2.6 hours) and uses the fewest channels (2.1 on average). But 94% still struggle to find enough volunteers. Self-nomination gives the most forgotten shifts of any method (11%), although the numbers are small.
- Depends on the event / ad hoc (n=20): These clubs spend among the most time each week (4.0 and 3.6 hours). They're also the most likely to be unsure of their hours (5 of 20). With no set method, every event starts from scratch.

No assignment method stops no-shows. Committee assignment trades a supply problem for an admin one

Share of clubs naming each challenge, by how duties are usually assigned (n=122)



Small bases: Committee assigns n=17, Depends n=9, Ad hoc n=11. Treat differences as indicative. 'Other' (n=4) not shown; see Table 22.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q8 by Q9, n=122

Chart 15: Reliability vs supply challenges by assignment method (Q8 x Q9)

Measure	Committee assigns	Mix of both	Self-nominate	Depends on event	Informal / ad hoc	Other	All clubs
Clubs (n)	17	46	35	9	11	4	122
No-shows	24% (4)	26% (12)	20% (7)	22% (2)	9% (1)	0% (0)	21% (26)
Chasing confirmations	12% (2)	17% (8)	17% (6)	11% (1)	18% (2)	0% (0)	16% (19)
Forgetting shifts	6% (1)	7% (3)	11% (4)	0% (0)	0% (0)	0% (0)	7% (8)
Any reliability issue	41% (7)	41% (19)	37% (13)	33% (3)	27% (3)	0% (0)	37% (45)
Knowing who is available	24% (4)	13% (6)	14% (5)	0% (0)	18% (2)	0% (0)	14% (17)
Volunteer burnout	29% (5)	50% (23)	34% (12)	56% (5)	36% (4)	0% (0)	40% (49)
Finding enough volunteers	65% (11)	91% (42)	94% (33)	100% (9)	100% (11)	100% (4)	90% (110)
Avg hrs/week (n estimating)	3.7 (16)	2.7 (41)	2.6 (33)	4.0 (6)	3.6 (9)	1.3 (2)	2.9 (107)
4+ hrs/week	25% (4)	17% (7)	15% (5)	50% (3)	44% (4)	0% (0)	21% (23)
Avg channels	2.5	2.7	2.1	3.6	2.9	2.3	2.6

Table 22: Challenges and time by assignment method (Q8 × Q9 × Q10)

Note: 7 of the 17 committee-assign clubs have 51 or more volunteers, so size and method overlap. With 51+ clubs excluded, committee-assign clubs still report lower rates of finding volunteers (70%, 7 of 10) and burnout (20%, 2 of 10), but on a very small base. All four "Other" write-ins named only the two supply challenges (finding volunteers and the same people helping).

Reliability problems (no-shows, chasing confirmations and forgotten shifts) are at about the same level whichever assignment method a club uses. The method changes where the effort goes. Clubs where the committee assigns duties report more trouble knowing who is available. Even among clubs where volunteers self-nominate, 94% struggle to find enough people.

What Connects These Findings

Across all three cross-cuts, the workload doesn't go away. It moves:

- Spread coordination across more channels, and the cost shows up as burnout and as work nobody can measure.
- Grow the club, and total hours rise while the load per person falls.
- Have the committee assign duties, and the supply problem turns into an availability and admin problem.

The survey's headline challenges (finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping) stay about the same across every cut. What changes is the set of secondary problems: burnout, no-shows, chasing confirmations and admin that nobody tracks.

08 · WHAT CLUBS WANT TO SEE CHANGE

Q11 asked: "If you could improve one thing about volunteer coordination at your club, what would it be?"

Of the 122 respondents, 110 gave a substantive answer. The other 12 said "not sure", "N/A" or that things already run well. Each answer was coded to a theme. 16 answers raised two distinct points and were counted under both, so theme counts add up to more than 110.

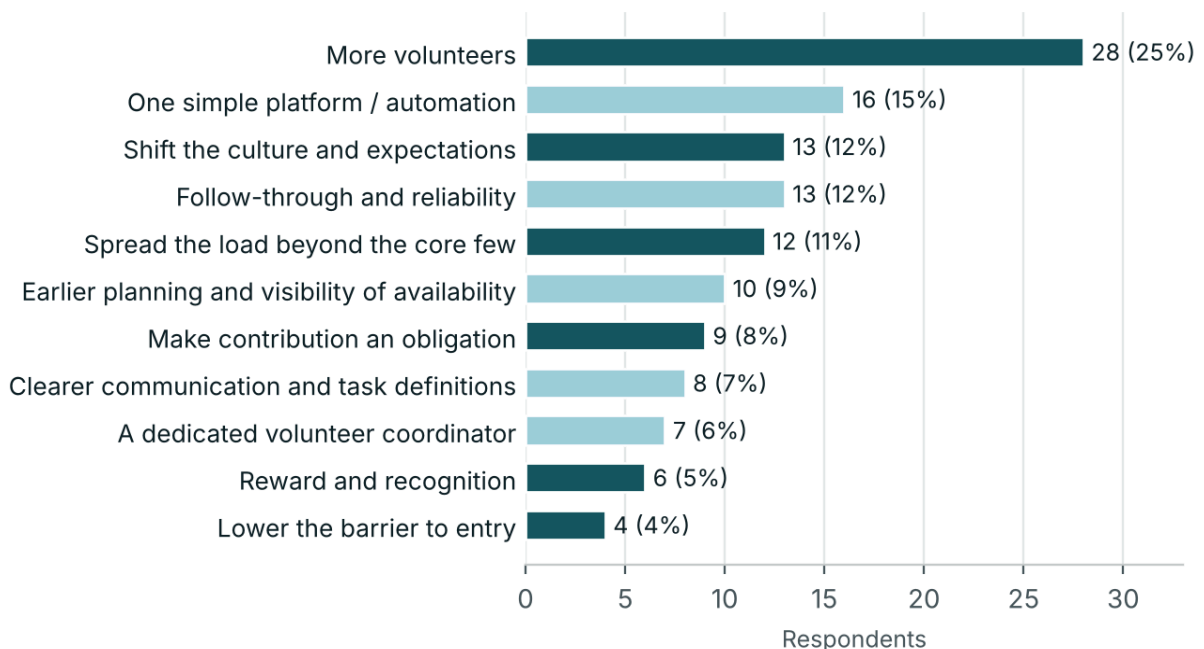
Recurring Themes

Each answer was coded to one or two themes. Chart 16 shows how often each theme came up, split into people-supply themes and coordination-mechanics themes.

What clubs would change about volunteer coordination

Themes in answers to 'If you could improve one thing about volunteer coordination at your club, what would it be?'

■ People supply ■ Coordination mechanics



Q11, open text, coded. n = 110 substantive answers. Some answers coded to two themes.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q11, n=110

Chart 16: Q11 theme frequency

Theme	Group	Respondents	% of 110
More volunteers	People supply	28	25%
One simple platform / automation	Mechanics	16	15%
Shift the culture and expectations	People supply	13	12%
Follow-through and reliability	Mechanics	13	12%
Spread the load beyond the core few	People supply	12	11%
Earlier planning and visibility of availability	Mechanics	10	9%
Make contribution an obligation	People supply	9	8%
Clearer communication and task definitions	Mechanics	8	7%
A dedicated volunteer coordinator	Mechanics	7	6%
Reward and recognition	People supply	6	5%
Lower the barrier to entry	People supply	4	4%
No change / not sure (excluded from chart)	-	12	-

Table 23: Q11 improvement themes (n=110 substantive answers)

Most answers were about getting people to help, not about organising them. The question asked about coordination, but 60% (66 of 110) answered with a supply problem: not enough people, the same few doing everything, a culture where fees are seen to cover it, or no way to make families contribute. 45% (49) named something about the mechanics: tools, planning, communication, reminders or a coordinator. Only 5 answers covered both.

Asked about coordination, most answered about people

Type of improvement named in Q11



n = 110 substantive Q11 answers

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q11, n=110

Chart 17: Supply vs mechanics split

Answer type	Respondents	% of 110
People supply only	61	55%
Coordination mechanics only	44	40%
Both	5	5%

Table 24: Supply vs mechanics answers (Q11, n=110)

Several respondents said outright that the question missed their real problem:

"The coordination is fine, the issue is getting parents of players to volunteer..."

"Can't coordinate when people don't volunteer. Volunteering is the problem."

The coordination answers centre on one place to do it. Among those who answered about mechanics, the most common request was a single tool: "one simple platform", "a central volunteer platform", "one truth - what volunteers are available, where do we need them". Next came follow-through: people turning up when rostered, fewer reminders and less chasing.

Clubs see fairness and visibility as the problem more than headcount. The "spread the load" and "obligation" themes are not asking for more people in general. They are asking for the non-contributors to be seen and held to account. Respondents mention tracking more than once ("Make it compulsory... issue is that would need to be tracked"; "Keeping track of volunteers so that we can reward them").

In Their Own Words

The same complaint, three ways. Three groups of answers make the same point in different words:

Not enough people help

- A numbers problem: *"More volunteers"*. 28 respondents said this, most in five words or fewer.
- A fairness problem: *"Too many expectations on the same people"*
- A culture problem: *"More people need to understand that fees don't pay for everything"*

People say yes, then don't show

- *"People committing and actually doing"*
- *"Getting them to do what they say"*
- *"People saying they want to be involved, actually being involved"*

Just give me the tool

- *"One simple platform"*
- *"A program to do it for me"*
- *"I'd design an app to do everything I currently do"*

"People actually volunteering instead of adopting the 'I've paid my fees I don't need to do anything' approach."

Registrar / Administrator · **Culture**

"Only having to ask once and not begging and begging in desperation multiple times."

Volunteer Coordinator, 51-100 volunteers · **Follow-through**

"One truth - what volunteers are available, where do we need them."

Committee Member, 100+ volunteers, 15+ hours a week on coordination · **Platform / visibility**

"...a lot comes down to thinking to help out you need to be on the committee, or if you volunteer once you're stuck doing that forever (which is kind of true because we have so few volunteers)."

Committee Member / Marketing Coordinator · **Barrier to entry**

"Would love to shut the canteen down for the game time if no one from that team has volunteered for their time slot, but we can't afford to lose any sales."

Committee Member, Coach / Manager · **Obligation**

09 · VOLUNTEER LEVIES AND INCENTIVES: FOLLOW-UP FINDINGS

About This Follow-Up

122 club officials responded to the main survey. 93 of them (76%) asked for a summary of the findings (Q12), and each of those 93 was sent a single follow-up question by email:

"Does your club use a volunteer levy, bond, or refundable fee to encourage families to pitch in? And if so, does it actually work?"

The 29 respondents who didn't ask for the findings were not contacted.

41 of the 93 replied, a response rate of 44%. Replies came from clubs of every size:

Active volunteers	Emailed	Replied	Response rate
Fewer than 10	20	6	30%
10-25	40	20	50%
26-50	19	10	53%
51 or more	14	5	36%
All	93	41	44%

Table 25: Follow-up response rate by club size

Many replies were a single line. Others described in detail what their club had tried and what happened.

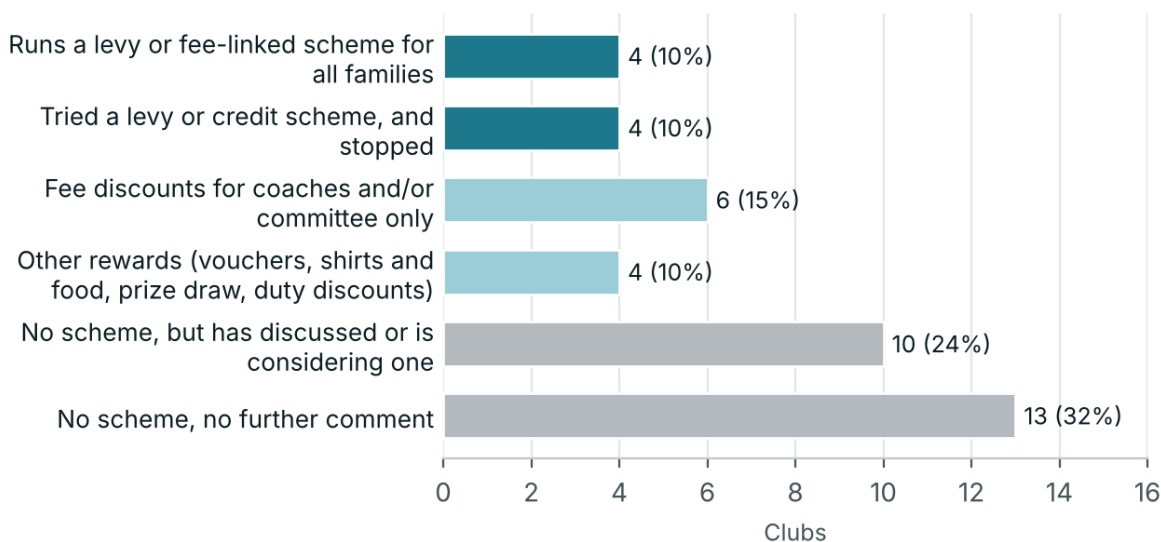
Data note: This is a small follow-up group of people who had already opted in. The question was open text and was not part of the original survey. The replies were coded by theme, and the figures are given as counts, not as estimates for the sport as a whole. Quotes are anonymised.

What Clubs Currently Do

Most clubs don't use a levy. Only 4 of the 41 clubs (10%) run a levy or fee-linked scheme that applies to all families. Another 4 have tried one and stopped. Fee discounts for coaches and committee members are more common than levies.

One in ten clubs runs a volunteer levy, and as many have tried one and stopped

Current approach to volunteer levies and incentives (follow-up email replies, n=41)



Each club coded to one main category. Percentages may not add to 100% because of rounding.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, follow-up email, n=41

Chart 18: Levy and incentive use among follow-up respondents

Current approach	Clubs	% of 41
Runs a levy or fee-linked scheme for all families	4	10%
Tried a levy or credit scheme, and stopped	4	10%
Fee discounts for coaches and/or committee only	6	15%
Other rewards (vouchers, shirts and food, prize draw, discounts for specific duties)	4	10%
No scheme, but has discussed or is considering one	10	24%
No scheme, no further comment	13	32%

Table 26: Current approach to levies and incentives (n=41)

The four schemes in use take different forms:

- A levy that is rebated to coaches and managers, with the committee planning to raise it next year
- A \$15 per-player levy that funds registration rebates for coaches and managers
- A refundable levy of \$60, returned to families who volunteer at least 4 hours
- A higher registration fee that includes a free presentation ticket for players who volunteer

Counting the two levy-funded schemes, 8 clubs (20%) give coaches or committee members reduced fees, ranging from \$150 to a full fee waiver. 10 clubs (24%) have discussed a levy at committee level without introducing one. Several respondents said it had been "mooted a few times" or "talked about many times".

Does It Work?

Mostly not, for general volunteering. 10 respondents described a levy or credit scheme they had run, or had seen run at another club. 6 of the 10 said it didn't increase volunteering.

Experience of a levy or credit scheme	Accounts
Didn't increase volunteering	6
Some or targeted success	2
Positive, but reported second-hand (other local clubs)	1
No verdict given	1
Total	10

Table 27: Experience of a levy or credit scheme

The most common failure was that families pay to opt out. As one respondent put it, "most people are happy to pay it and not volunteer". At a club with a refundable levy, "it's still always the same small number who far exceed the minimum requirement". Two clubs dropped their levy after finding it "made no difference". A third club dropped theirs too, and the respondent assumed "it wasn't working if we decided to stop".

The two partial successes have one thing in common: the incentive is attached to something specific. One club funds rebates for coaches and managers from its levy and says it "appears to work" for those roles. The other offered senior players a free presentation ticket for volunteering, and got "some more help... than previous years". A third respondent had seen nearby clubs' fee discounts "massively improve the culture around volunteering", though that was second-hand.

A levy works better as a reward for a defined role than as a charge on families who don't help. It does little to solve the main problem in Q9 (Table 13), the same people always helping.

Why Clubs Hold Back

Clubs that considered a levy and decided against it gave four reasons:

- **It lets families buy their way out.** "Parents can pretty much buy their way out of volunteering... it's not as if we can pay staff to come in and do the shifts."
- **Fairness and financial pressure.** Clubs struggle to set a level high enough to work "whilst not penalising families that... are unable to volunteer their time and/or face financial stress."
- **It adds admin.** A levy only works if someone tracks who has volunteered, the same record-keeping gap noted in Key Takeaways for Club Committees (point 2).
- **It cuts against volunteering culture.** Some clubs prefer small rewards: a \$10 canteen voucher per shift, a free shirt and food, or a prize draw for next season's registration.

Interest stays high despite the doubts. One respondent wrote "We don't have a levy but wish we did", and another "would be keen to hear how other clubs manage that". Clubs want a proven model, which supports Key Takeaways for Associations (point 2).

What the follow-up adds

In Q11, clubs asked for volunteering to be expected or compulsory. The follow-up shows that the most common way of trying this, a levy, usually doesn't work when it is used on its own. A levy measures payment, not participation. The schemes with some success reward a clearly defined contribution, and every scheme depends on someone keeping track of who has helped.

10 · KEY TAKEAWAYS

Five patterns appear throughout the report

- Not having enough volunteers is the main problem.
- A small core of people carries the load.
- Burnout is higher where that load is spread across too many channels.
- The way a club assigns duties changes where the work falls, but not how much there is.
- Most of the admin goes unmeasured.

The takeaways below turn those findings into points for the two groups who can act on them. They come from the survey data only. They are not tied to any product or solution.

90% Named finding enough volunteers as a top-three challenge	90% Named the same people always helping	51% vs 31% Burnout among clubs using 3+ channels vs 1–2 (full sample)	40–60 hrs Typical coordination admin per club, per season	70% Want to hear about practical help that is developed or piloted
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Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, n=122

For Club Committees

1. **Treat volunteering as a people problem first and a tools problem second.** Finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping were each named by 90% of respondents. 98% named at least one of the two. When asked what they would change, 60% of respondents answered about getting people to help, not about organising them. Better tools reduce admin, but they won't bring in new volunteers on their own.

What this means: Start by making the pool bigger. Some clubs set team-based quotas, such as each team supplying helpers for its home games. Short, clearly defined tasks also help. They answer a worry several respondents raised: that volunteering once means "you're stuck doing that forever".

2. **Make contribution visible, so the load can be shared fairly.** The "spread the load" and "make it an obligation" answers in Q11 (21 coded mentions) aren't asking for more people in general. They're asking for the people who don't help to be seen. Yet only 5% named "keeping track of who has helped" as a top challenge. Clubs want fairness, but most don't keep the records that would show it.

What this means: Keep a simple record of who has done what across the season, and share it with families. That gives the committee something factual to point to when asking families to step up. Any levy or incentive scheme depends on this record.

3. **Protect the core few, especially in small clubs.** 40% of clubs named burnout, rising to 54% in clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers. Those clubs cover a median of 7 volunteer-dependent activities, the same spread as clubs five times their size. They spend about 19 minutes of coordination per volunteer each week, against about 2 minutes in clubs with 100+.

What this means: Small clubs should check which activities they can drop, combine or share with another club. They should also make sure the people coordinating aren't working every match-day duty as well.

4. **Cut the number of channels.** Clubs using three or more channels reported burnout at 51%, against 31% for clubs using one or two. The gap is smaller among website-form respondents (10 points), but it points the same way. The gap held in three of the four size bands. Those clubs were also three times as likely to be unsure how long coordination takes (19% vs 6%). The most common setup, used by 28% of clubs, keeps the roster in a spreadsheet and handles reminders and swaps in a chat app.

What this means: Keep the roster in one place and send updates through one channel. Few committees describe "too many tools" as a problem (1%). The cost shows up as tired people and work that nobody can see.

5. **Choose an assignment method on purpose, and plan for no-shows whichever you use.**

No-shows sat at 20-26% across committee assignment, a mix of methods and self-nomination. Each method moves the work somewhere else:

- Committee assignment had the lowest supply pressure (65%) but the most trouble knowing who is available (24%).
- A mix of methods had the highest burnout (50%).
- Clubs with no set method spent among the most time each week (3.6-4.0 hours).

What this means: Pick one main method and use it consistently. Confirm volunteers closer to the day, and have a backup plan for every duty.

6. **Measure the workload.** 12% of respondents couldn't estimate their weekly coordination time, rising to 25% in clubs with 26-50 volunteers. Clubs that gave an estimate typically spend 40-60 hours a season, and that figure probably understates the off-season work.

What this means: Track coordination hours for one season. The figure supports the case for splitting the role, adding a dedicated coordinator (named by 6% in Q11), and planning the handover when office bearers step down.

Clubs with 26-50 volunteers

This band appears in nearly every cross-cut. It is the most fragmented group (3.3 channels on average, 71% using three or more). It is the most likely to name chasing confirmations (38%) and the least sure of its hours (25% unsure). It is also the most likely to mix assignment methods (50%). These clubs have outgrown informal coordination but haven't moved to a structured system. They have the most to gain from consolidating.

#	Takeaway	Key figure	Report section
1	People problem first	98% named a supply challenge; 60% of Q11 answers about supply	Biggest Challenges; What Clubs Want
2	Make contribution visible	21 Q11 mentions of spreading the load or obligations; 5% track who helps	What Clubs Want; Ranking the Top Challenges
3	Protect the core few	Burnout 54% in clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers; 19 min per volunteer per week	Challenges By Club Size; Club Size Against Weekly Admin Hours
4	Cut the number of channels	Burnout 51% (3+ channels) vs 31% (1-2 channels)	Tool Count Against Challenge Count
5	Choose an assignment method on purpose	No-shows 20-26% under every main method	Assignment Method Against No-Shows
6	Measure the workload	12% unsure (25% in 26-50 clubs); 40-60 hrs per season	Weekly Time; What This Adds Up To Across A Season

Table 28: Committee takeaways and supporting evidence

For Associations And Governing Bodies

1. **Volunteer supply is a problem across the sport, not a failure of individual clubs.** The two supply challenges were named by around 90% of respondents in almost every cut in this report. The exceptions were clubs with 51+ volunteers (71-76%) and clubs where the committee assigns duties, where 65% named finding enough volunteers, although 7 of those 17 clubs are also 51+ clubs. 12% of Q11 answers were about volunteering culture and expectations, including the view that registration fees cover everything ("fees don't pay for everything"). Individual clubs can't change that view on their own.

What this means: Associations can set expectations across the whole competition. That could mean consistent messages to families at registration and season launch, explaining that grassroots football runs on volunteers.

2. **Clubs want contribution to be expected, but they lack the means to require it.** Nine respondents asked for volunteering to be compulsory. Others described what stops them, for example: "Would love to shut the canteen down... but we can't afford to lose any sales." Clubs want to enforce contribution but fear losing revenue or members if they try.

What this means: Associations can provide model policies, registration-time volunteer commitments and guidance on volunteer levies or credits. This takes the pressure off any single club acting alone.

The follow-up on levies (see Volunteer Levies And Incentives: Follow-up Findings, Table 27) shows that charging families who don't help rarely works. Rewards for defined roles are a stronger starting point.

3. **Focus support on small clubs.** Clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers have the highest burnout (54%) and the heaviest load per volunteer (about 8 times that of the largest clubs). They also cover nearly the same range of activities as larger clubs. They were also the most willing to hear about practical help: 77% opted in at Q13, against 52% of clubs with 51+ volunteers.

What this means: Shared resources, simpler admin and compliance requirements, and pooled volunteers for events such as gala days help small clubs more, relative to their size, than they help large ones.

4. **Help mid-sized clubs make the move to a structured system.** The 26-50 band uses the most channels, has the most trouble chasing confirmations and is the least sure of its workload. It is the group in transition between informal and structured coordination.

What this means: Practical guidance on rostering and on consolidating channels is most likely to make a difference in this band.

5. **Recognise coordination as volunteer work.** The 107 respondents who gave an estimate account for about 6,300 hours of coordination admin a season. That work happens before anyone does a duty and goes largely unseen. As an illustration only, an association of 50 clubs at the typical 40-60 hours per club carries 2,000-3,000 hours of coordination admin each season.

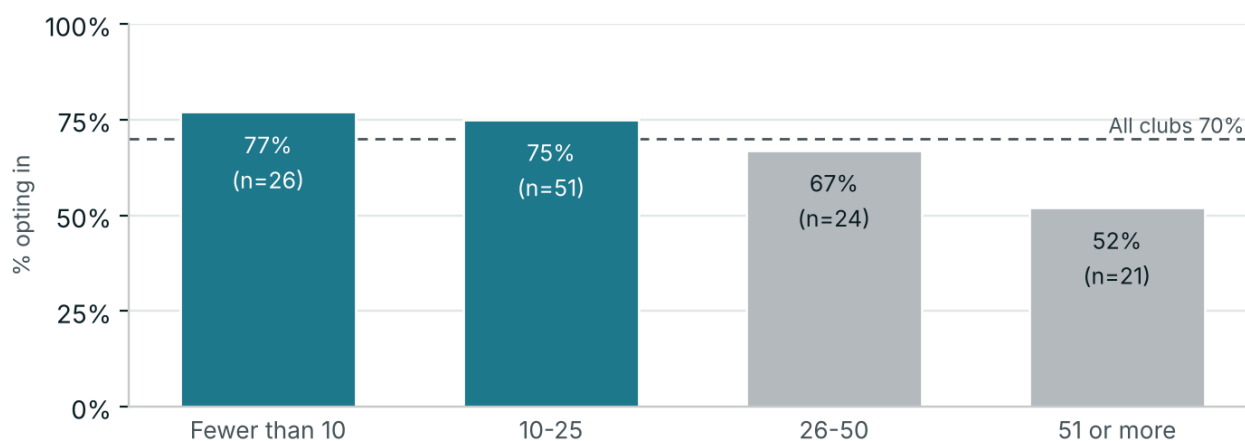
What this means: Volunteer recognition programs, awards and volunteer counts should include rostering and coordination roles, not just match-day duties. "Reward and recognition" came up unprompted in Q11.

6. **Clubs are willing to take part, so involve them.** 76% of respondents asked for the findings and 70% want to hear about anything developed or piloted. Respondents came from at least 67 clubs across five states, and the survey was organised and distributed independently of any association or governing body.

What this means: Associations and governing bodies can involve clubs directly in designing support. A future survey sent out through associations would allow state-by-state comparisons, which this survey could not make (see A Note On Interpreting This Data).

Smaller clubs are the most open to practical help

Share of respondents who want to hear about practical help that is developed or piloted (Q13), by active volunteers per season (n=122)



51-100 and 100+ combined (n = 7 and n = 14). The 25-point gap between the smallest and largest bands is indicative because of the small bases.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q13 by Q4, n=122

Chart 19: Interest in practical help by club size (Q13 x Q4)

Active volunteers	n	Opted in (Q13 = Yes)	%
Fewer than 10	26	20	77%
10-25	51	38	75%
26-50	24	16	67%
51 or more	21	11	52%
All clubs	122	85	70%

Table 29: Interest in practical help by club size (Q13 × Q4)

#	Takeaway	Key figure	Report section
1	Supply is a sport-wide problem	Around 90% across nearly every cut; 12% of Q11 answers about fee culture	Biggest Challenges; Where the Patterns Connect
2	Clubs want contribution to be expected	9 Q11 calls to make it compulsory	What Clubs Want
3	Focus support on small clubs	Burnout 54%; about 8× load per volunteer; 77% open to help	Challenges By Club Size; Club Size Against Weekly Admin Hours
4	Help mid-sized clubs move to a structured system	3.3 channels; 38% chasing; 25% unsure	Fragmentation; Club Size Against Weekly Admin Hours
5	Recognise coordination as volunteer work	About 6,300 hrs across 107 respondents per season	What This Adds Up To Across A Season
6	Involve clubs	76% want the findings; 70% open to pilots; 67+ clubs	Methodology

Table 30: Association takeaways and supporting evidence

11 · A NOTE FROM ROSTERDAY

Thank you to the 122 club officials who took the time to complete this survey, and to the 41 who answered the follow-up question on volunteer levies. Most of you already give your evenings and weekends to your club, so I appreciate the extra time you gave this.

This research was run by RosterDay, which I founded. I'm building a volunteer rostering tool for grassroots football clubs. The survey was deliberately written to name no product or solution, so the answers would reflect how clubs actually work rather than what I hoped to hear. The findings in this report stand on their own, whatever any club decides to use.

I've served on a grassroots football club committee myself, so many of these answers were familiar: the same few people covering every shift, the WhatsApp messages on a Friday night, and families who assume their registration fees cover everything. Seeing it confirmed by 122 club officials from at least 67 clubs across five states made it clear this isn't one club's problem.

Many of you asked to stay involved. 76% (93) requested a summary of the findings, and this report is that summary. 70% (85) asked to hear about practical ways to reduce admin and improve volunteer coordination. I'll contact those respondents directly, and only them.

If you have questions about the findings, or would like to share how your club handles volunteers, I'd like to hear from you.

Attila

Founder, RosterDay

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APPENDIX A · FULL SURVEY INSTRUMENT

This appendix reproduces the complete survey instrument as presented to respondents, including section structure, question wording, response options and routing logic. Question wording and response options are shown as they appeared in the live forms. Differences between the Google Form and website version are noted.

A.1 Instrument overview

Attribute	Detail
Survey title	RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026
Platform	Google Forms, then a web form on rosterday.com.au
Stated completion time	Approx. 2 minutes
Field period	26 May to 30 September 2026
Total questions	15 (14 on the Google Form)
Required questions	13 (Q1-Q13)
Optional questions	2 (Q14 contact email, Q15 club name)
Sections	5 (including Thank You page)
Routing	Single screening branch at Q1 (Google Form only)
Target respondents	Committee members, administrators, volunteer coordinators and others involved in organising club operations

Table A1: Instrument overview

A.2 Respondent introduction

The following introduction was displayed at the top of both forms:

We're conducting a short 2-minute research survey to better understand how grassroots sporting clubs organise volunteers and staffing for club activities such as match days, gala days, fundraising events, presentation days, canteens, working bees and other club operations.

We're interested in understanding what works well, what challenges clubs face, and how volunteer coordination could be made easier for community sport.

This survey is for committee members, administrators, volunteer coordinators and others involved in organising club operations.

** Indicates required question*

A.3 Survey structure and routing

Section	Title	Questions	Purpose
1	Screening	Q1	Confirms involvement in volunteer or operations coordination
2	About You & Your Club	Q2-Q4	Respondent role, sport type, club volunteer base size
3	Volunteer Coordination	Q5-Q11	Activities, frequency, current methods, assignment, challenges, time spent, improvement priority
4	Survey Results & Follow-up	Q12-Q15	Opt-in for results summary, pilot interest, contact email, club name
5	Thank You	-	Survey completion

Table A2: Survey structure

Q1 response	Routes to
Yes, I regularly organise volunteers/staffing	Q2 (Section 2)
Yes, I occasionally help organise volunteers/staffing	Q2 (Section 2)
I'm involved in club leadership but not volunteer coordination	Q2 (Section 2)
No	Section 5 (Thank You) on the Google Form. The website form did not apply this branch, so respondents answering 'No' continued to Q2.

Table A3: Routing

A.4 Question-by-question instrument

Section 1 - Screening

Q1. Are you currently involved in organising volunteers, staffing, or operations for a grassroots sporting club? *(Required)*

Format: Single choice

- Yes, I regularly organise volunteers/staffing
- Yes, I occasionally help organise volunteers/staffing
- I'm involved in club leadership but not volunteer coordination
- No

Section 2 - About You & Your Club

Q2. What is your role at the club? (Select all that apply) *(Required)*

Format: Multiple select, with "Other" free text

- President / Chairperson
- Secretary
- Treasurer
- Registrar / Administrator
- Volunteer Coordinator
- Team / Age Coordinator
- Committee Member
- Coach / Manager
- Event Coordinator
- Other (free text)

Q3. What type of sporting club are you involved with? *(Required)*

Format: Single choice, with "Other" free text

- Football / Soccer
- AFL
- Rugby League / Union
- Cricket
- Basketball
- Netball
- Tennis
- Swimming
- Athletics
- Multi-sport club
- Other (free text)

Note: The Google Form listed all the sports above. The survey was then focused on football clubs, where RosterDay's work is concentrated, and the website form listed Football only. All 122 responses in this report are from football clubs.

Q4. Approximately how many active volunteers or committee helpers does your club rely on each season? (Required)

Format: Single choice

- Fewer than 10
- 10-25
- 26-50
- 51-100
- 100+

Section 3 - Volunteer Coordination

Q5. What kinds of club activities require volunteers or staffing? (Select all that apply) (Required)

Format: Multiple select, with "Other" free text

- Weekly sporting rounds / match days
- Gala days / tournaments
- Presentation days
- Fundraising events
- Working bees / maintenance
- Canteen / BBQ / gate duty
- Registration days
- Committee meetings / admin support
- Other (free text)

Q6. How often are volunteers needed for club activities? (Required)

Format: Single choice, with "Other" free text

- Weekly
- Fortnightly
- Monthly
- Only for special events
- Rarely
- Other (free text)

Q7. How does your club currently organise volunteers and duty rosters? (Select all that apply)*(Required)*

Format: Multiple select, with "Other" free text

- Spreadsheets
- Email
- SMS / text messages
- WhatsApp
- Facebook Messenger / group chat
- Team app / club app
- Sign-up forms (Google Forms, SignUpGenius, etc.)
- Dedicated roster/scheduling software
- Phone calls
- Pen & paper / manual process
- Other (free text)

Q8. How are volunteers usually assigned to duties? (Required)

Format: Single choice, with "Other" free text

- Committee manually assigns people
- Volunteers nominate themselves
- A mix of assigning and self-selection
- Mostly informal / ad hoc
- Depends on the event
- Other (free text)

Q9. What are the biggest challenges your club faces when organising volunteers? (Select the top 3) (Required)

Format: Multiple select, with "Other" free text

- Finding enough volunteers
- The same people always helping
- Last-minute cancellations / no-shows
- Chasing confirmations or responses
- Communicating roster changes
- Knowing who is available
- Creating rosters takes too much time
- Keeping track of who has helped
- Volunteers forgetting shifts
- Poor visibility across events
- Too many tools/messages to manage
- Volunteer burnout
- Other (free text)

Q10. Roughly how much time does your club spend organising volunteers for a typical week? (Required)

Format: Single choice

- Less than 1 hour
- 1-3 hours
- 4-7 hours
- 8-15 hours
- 15+ hours
- Unsure

Q11. If you could improve one thing about volunteer coordination at your club, what would it be? (Required)

Format: Open text (long answer)

Section 4 - Survey Results & Follow-up

Q12. Would you be interested in receiving a summary of what grassroots sporting clubs told us in this survey? *(Required)*

Format: Single choice

- Yes
- No

Q13. We may explore practical ways to help clubs reduce admin and improve volunteer coordination in future. Would you like to hear about anything useful we develop or pilot, at no cost? *(Required)*

Format: Single choice

- Yes
- No

Q14. If yes, what is the best contact email? *(Optional)*

Format: Short text

Q15. Club name? *(Optional)* (Website form only)

Format: Short text

Section 5 - Thank You

Survey completion page. No questions.

A.5 Question format summary

Format	Count	Questions
Single choice	8	Q1, Q3, Q4, Q6, Q8, Q10, Q12, Q13
Multiple select	4	Q2, Q5, Q7, Q9
Open text (long)	1	Q11
Short text	2	Q14, Q15
Total	15	

Table A4: Question format summary

Questions with an "Other" free-text option: Q2, Q3, Q5, Q6, Q7, Q8, Q9 (7 of 15).

A.6 Instrument notes relevant to interpretation

Keep these points in mind when reading the results:

- Q1 screening scope.** Seven respondents answered 'No' to Q1 but completed the survey. They hold club roles and are included in all results. In 'Who We Surveyed' they are grouped with respondents not directly coordinating volunteers.
- Q9 "top 3" instruction not enforced.** The form did not limit Q9 to three selections, so some respondents picked fewer and some picked more. Percentages are calculated against respondents, not selections, so totals exceed 100%. Q9 results show how widely each challenge is felt, not a strict ranking of priorities.
- Q10 weekly framing.** Time spent is framed per typical week. Clubs that indicated volunteers are needed only for special events or rarely (Q6) may have found the weekly framing less applicable, which may contribute to "Unsure" or lower-band responses.
- Q14 conditional wording.** Q14 says "If yes" but did not depend on the answer to Q12 or Q13. Contact emails were used to send the results, the follow-up levy question and pilot updates, and to count distinct clubs. They are not part of any data in this report.
- Open-text coding.** Q11 responses and all "Other" free-text entries were coded thematically for analysis.
- Q15 club name (website form only).** Q15 was added to the website version. Responses from the Google Form do not include a club name, so the distinct-club count is a minimum.